

Screen sector statistics to March 2026

BFI Research and Statistics Unit

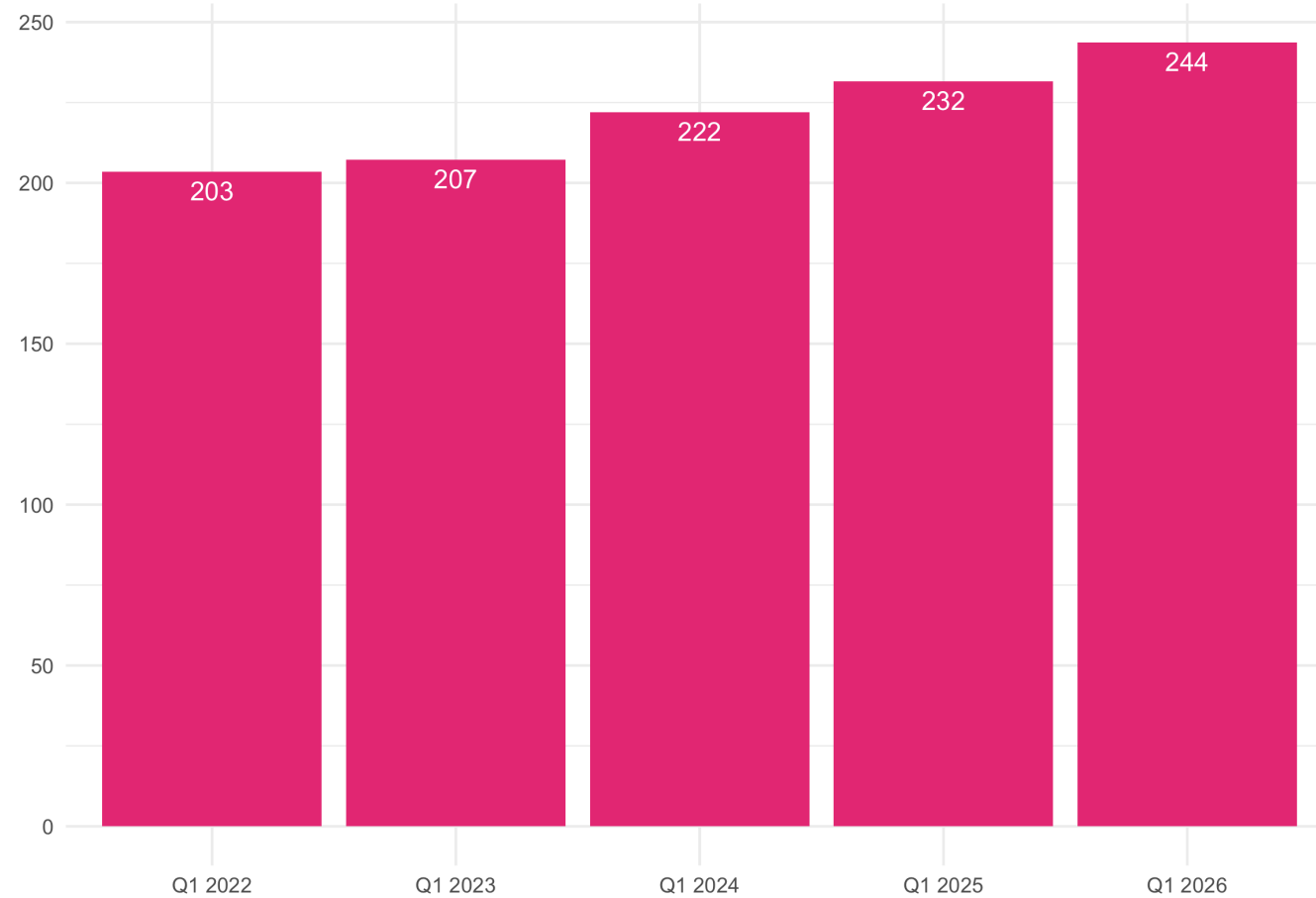
May 31, 2026

UK box office and admissions

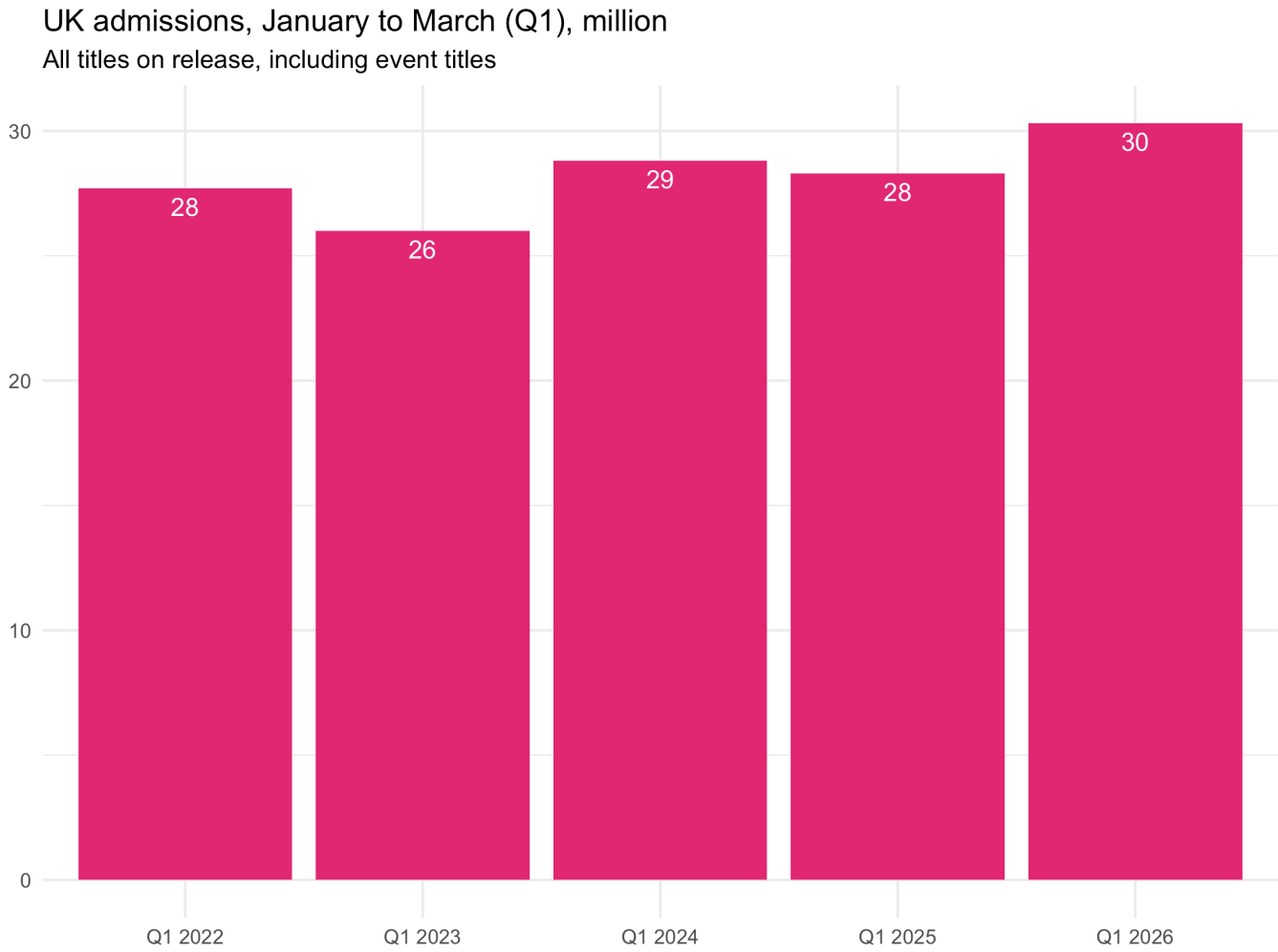
In the UK in the period
January to March (Q1) 2026:

- Box office revenue was
£244 million, up 5% on Q1
2025.

UK box office, January to March (Q1), £ million
All titles on release, including event titles

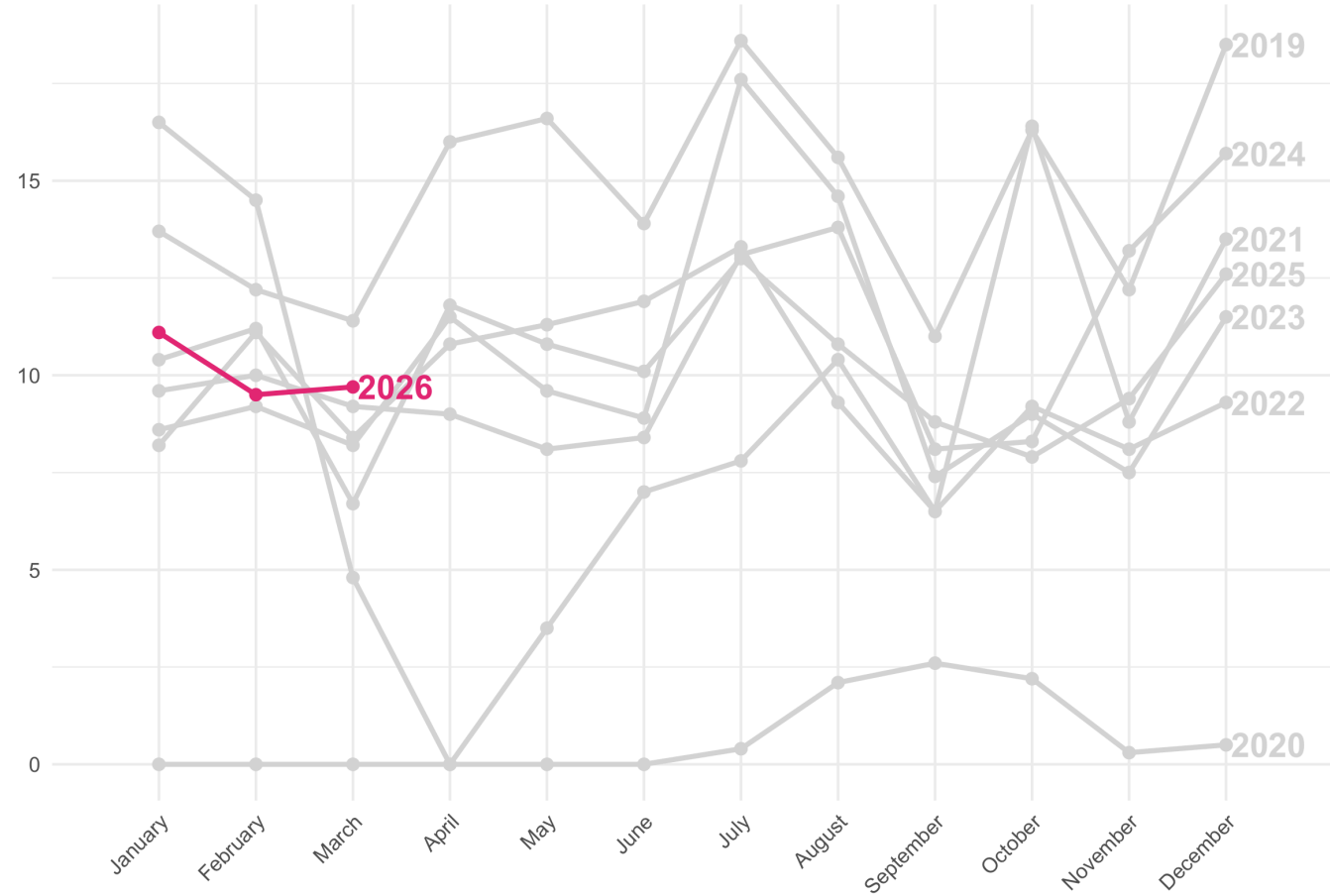


- There were 30 million cinema admissions, up 7% on Q1 2025.
- Figures are for all films on release, including event releases and those that started their release prior to the Q1 period.



- January recorded Q1 2026's highest monthly admissions, at 11 million.
- *The Housemaid*, *Avatar: Fire & Ash* and *Hamnet* were the highest earning releases of that month.

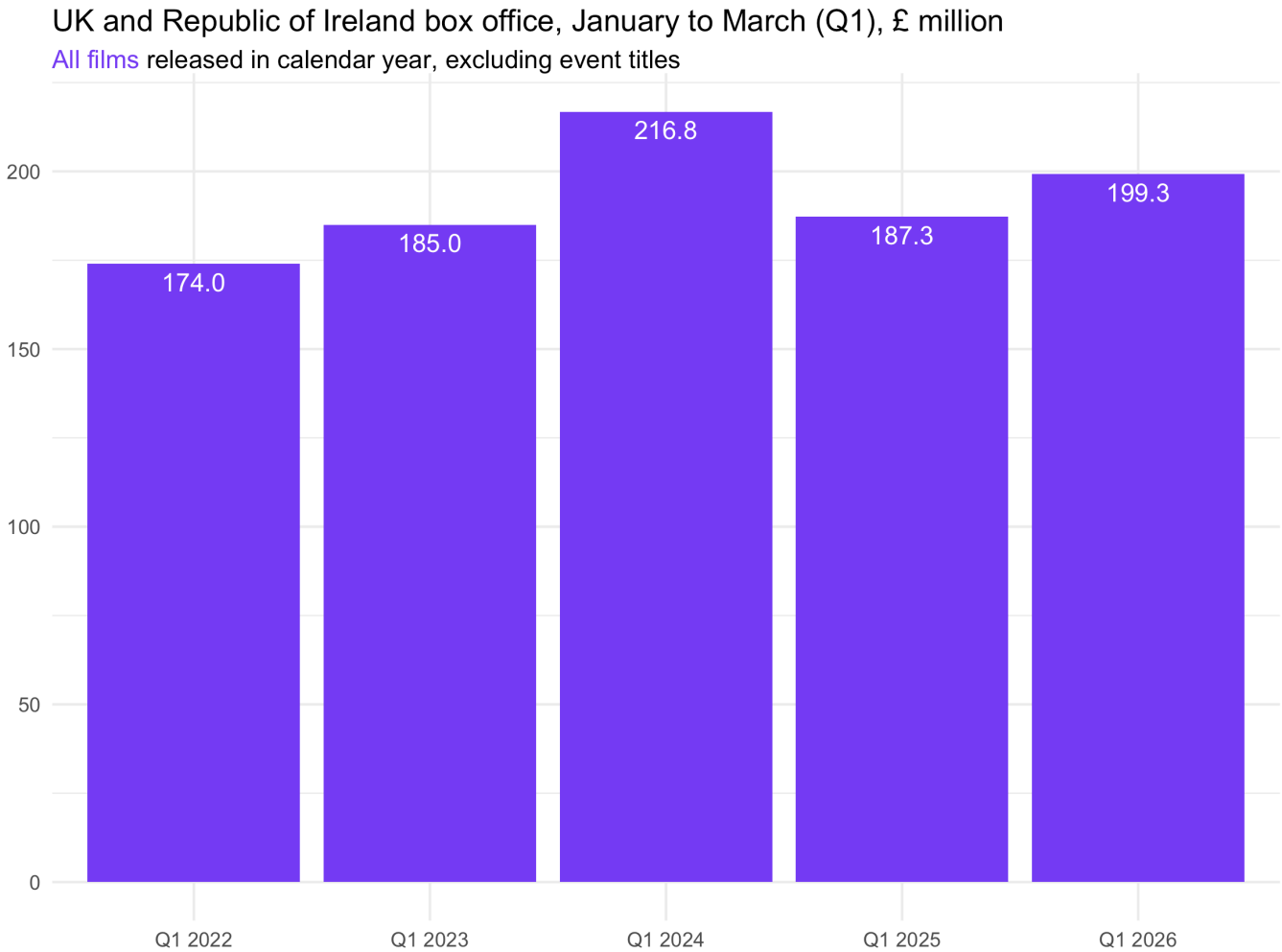
UK admissions, million, by month
All titles on release, including event titles



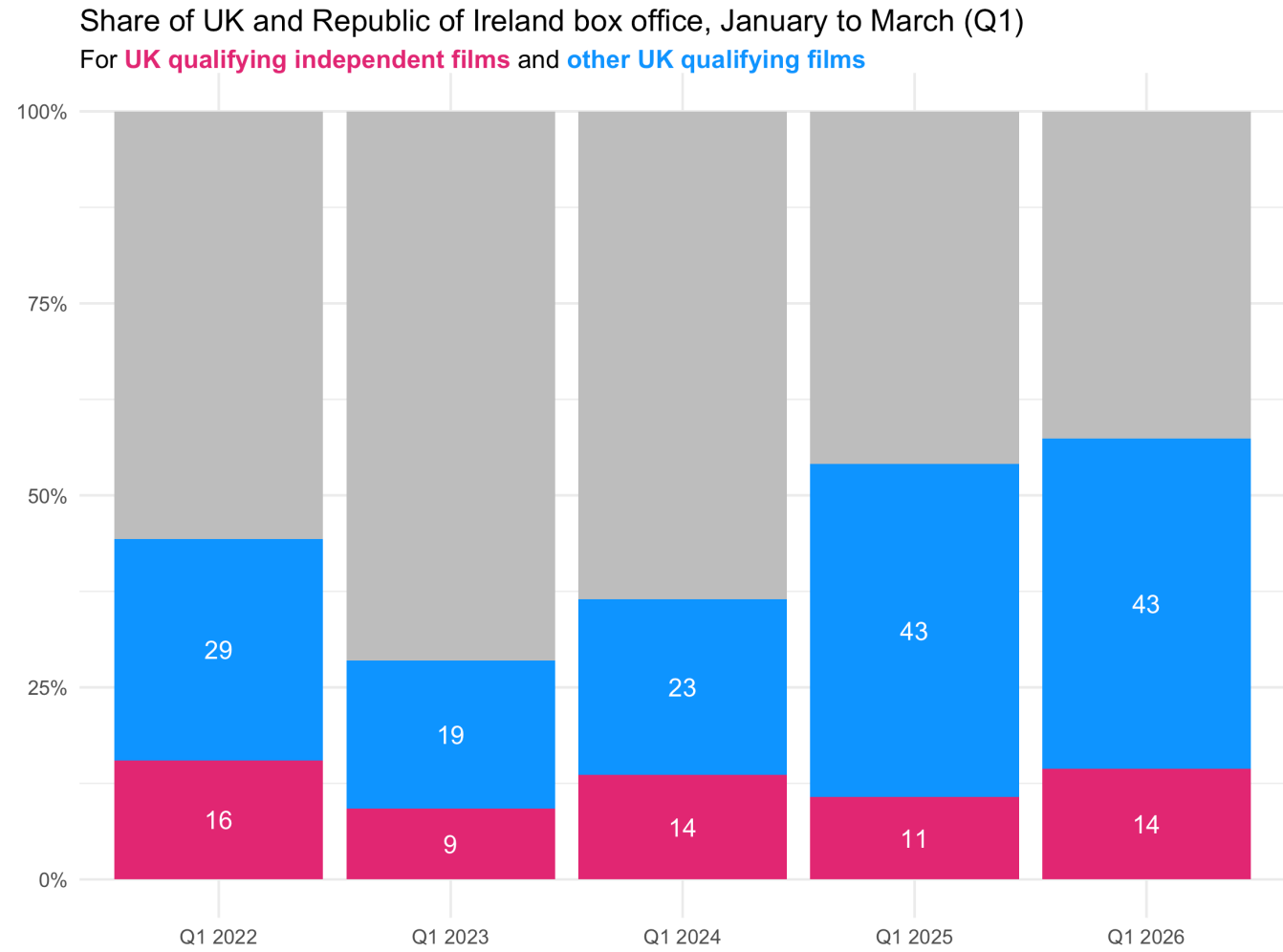
**UK and Republic of
Ireland box office**

At the UK and Republic of Ireland (ROI) box office:

- Revenue for films released in Q1 2026 was £199 million, up 6% on Q1 2025.
- This excludes event releases.



- The total market share of all UK qualifying films was 57.4%, approximately 3 percentage points higher than Q1 2025's UK qualifying share.

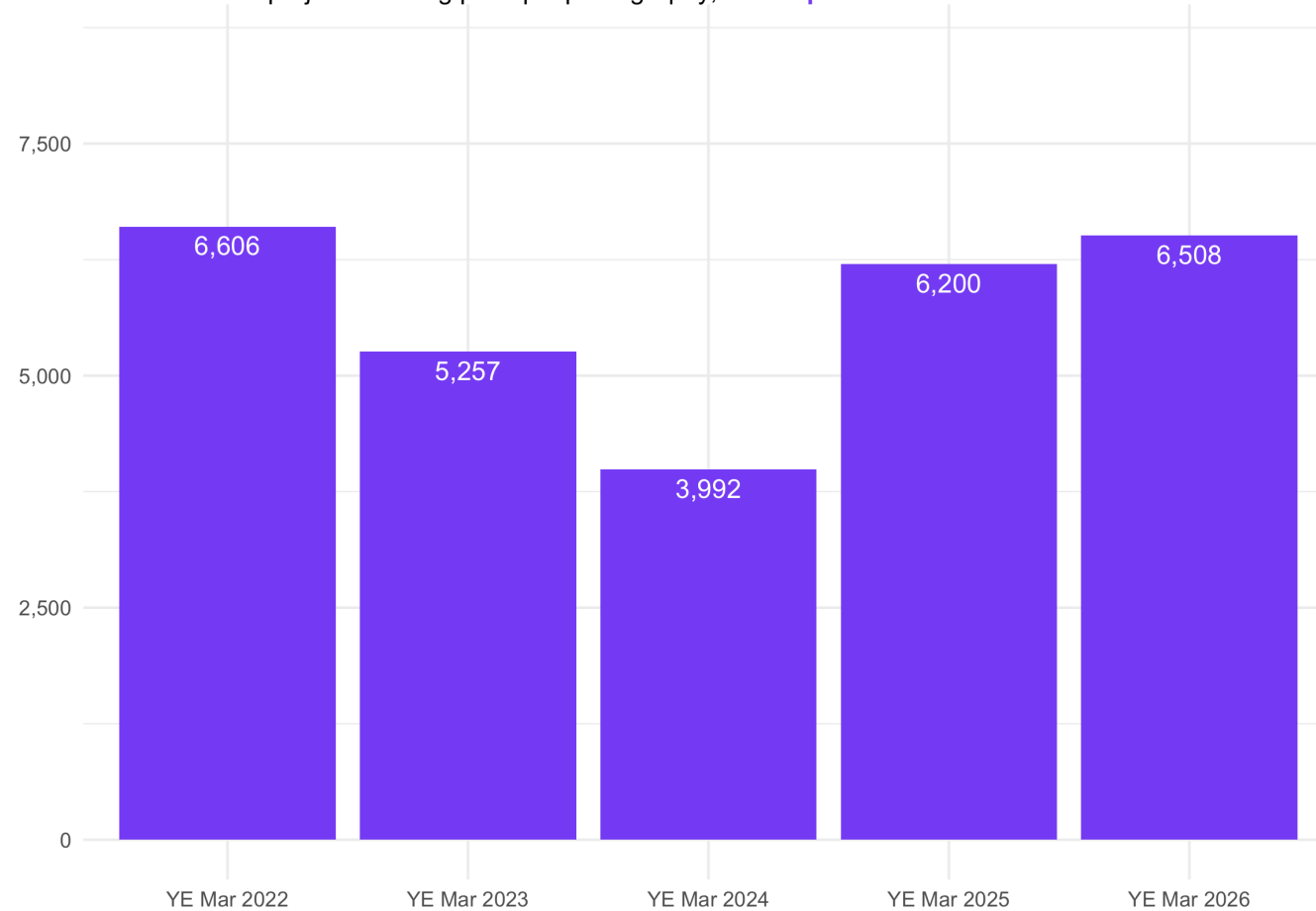


Film and HETV
production spend

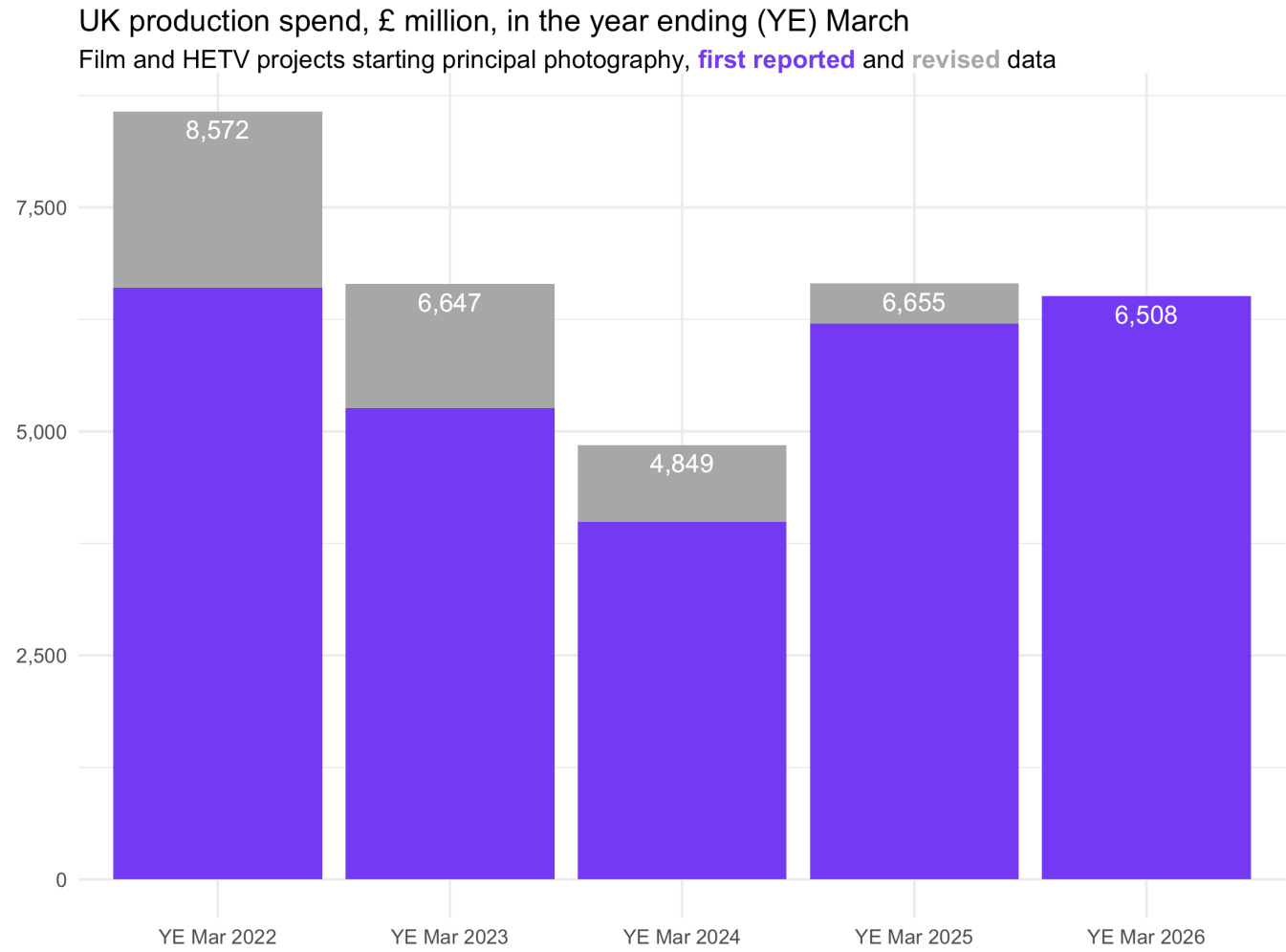
In the UK, in the 12 months to March 2026:

- The combined total spend on film and high-end television (HETV) production was £6.51 billion, up 5% on the previous 12-month period.
- This graph shows the figures that were ‘first reported’ for production spend in each 12-month period.

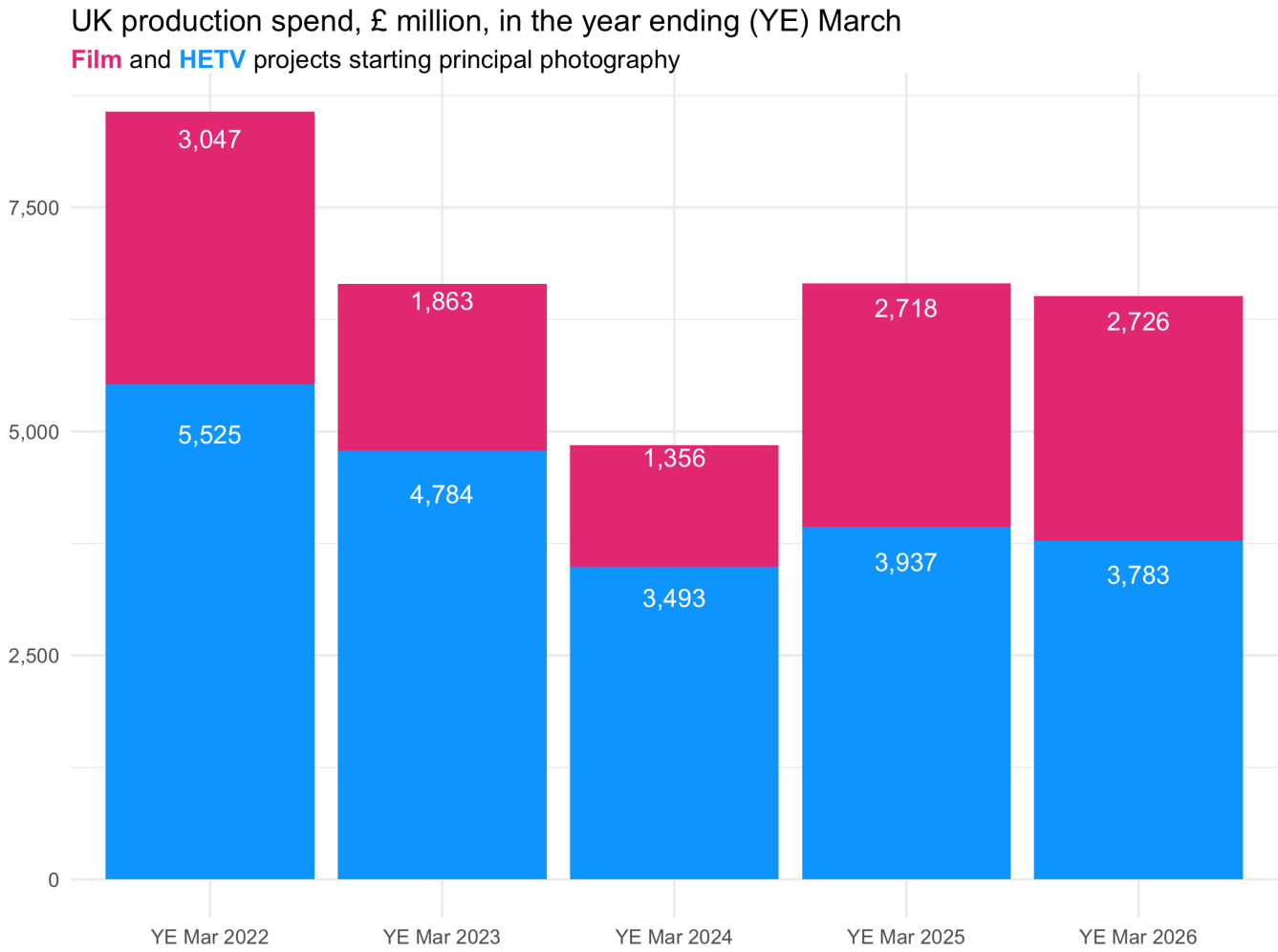
UK production spend, £ million, in the year ending (YE) March
Film and HETV projects starting principal photography, **first reported** data



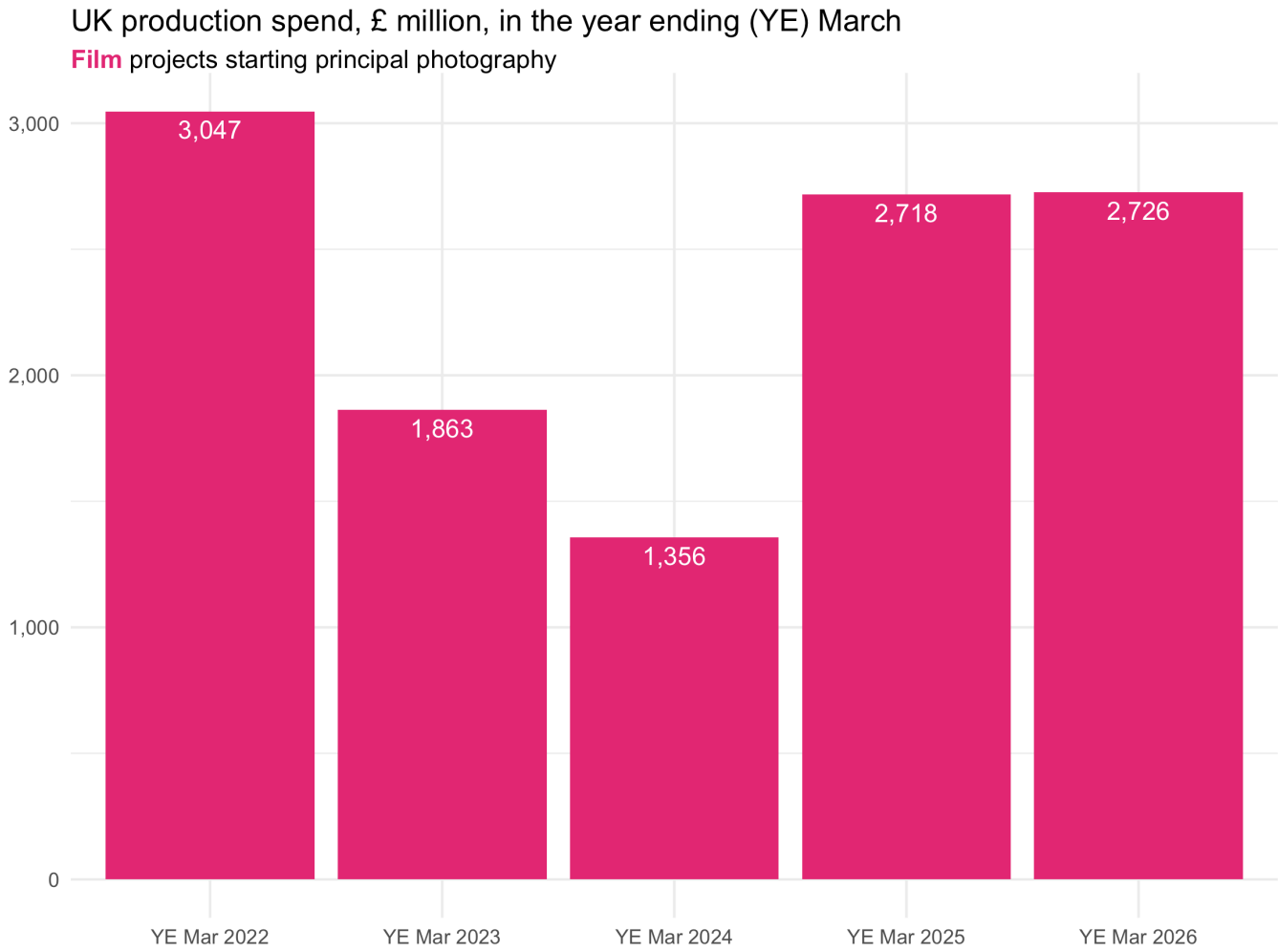
- Production data is revised every period to account for lags in obtaining complete data across all types of productions.
- Combined spend for the 12 months to March 2026 was down 2% on revised figures for the previous 12-month period.



- HETV accounted for 58% of UK production spend in the 12 months to March 2026.



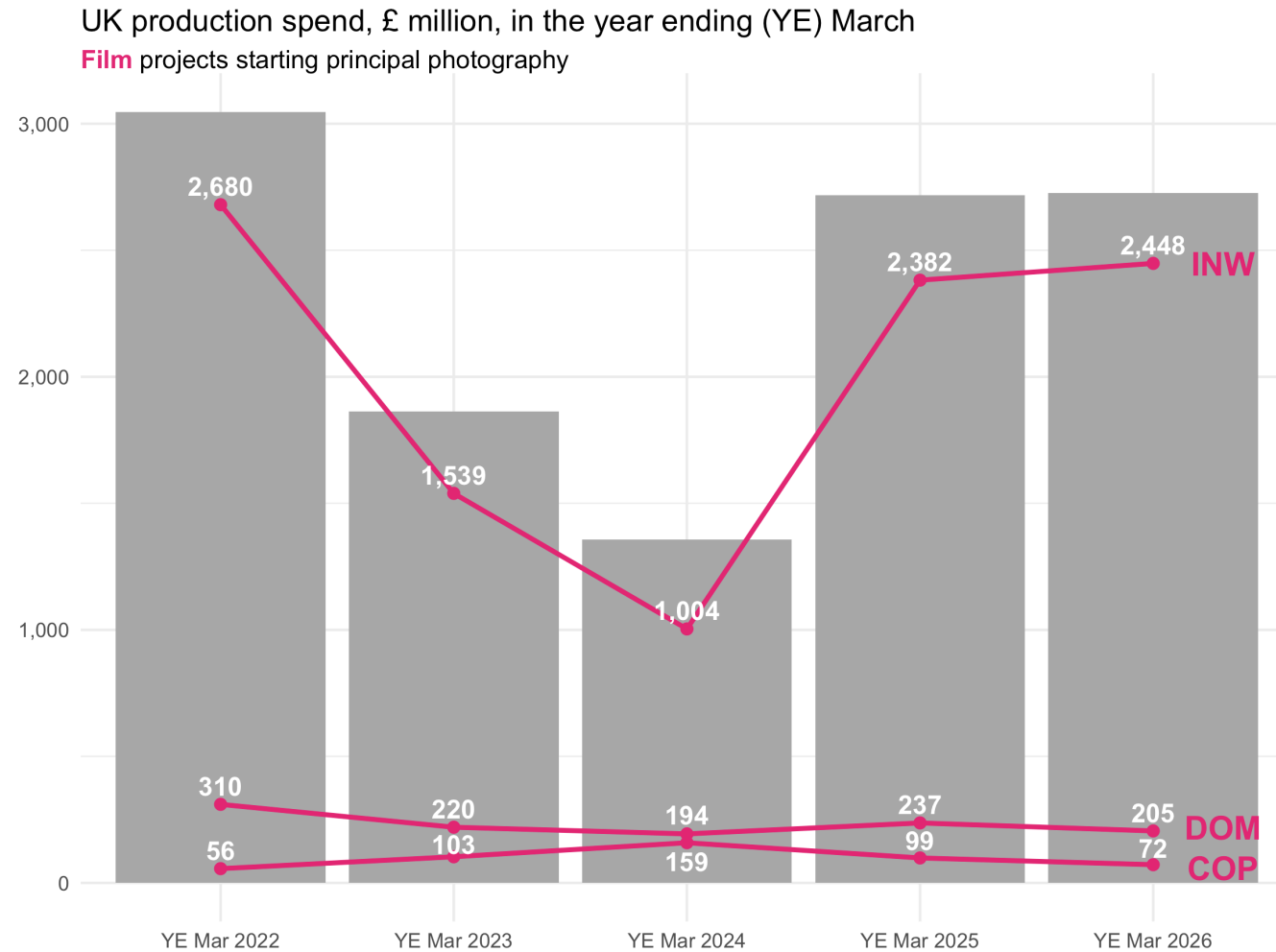
- UK spend on film production was £2.73 billion for the 12 months ending March 2026, up 0% compared with revised figures for the 12 months ending March 2025.



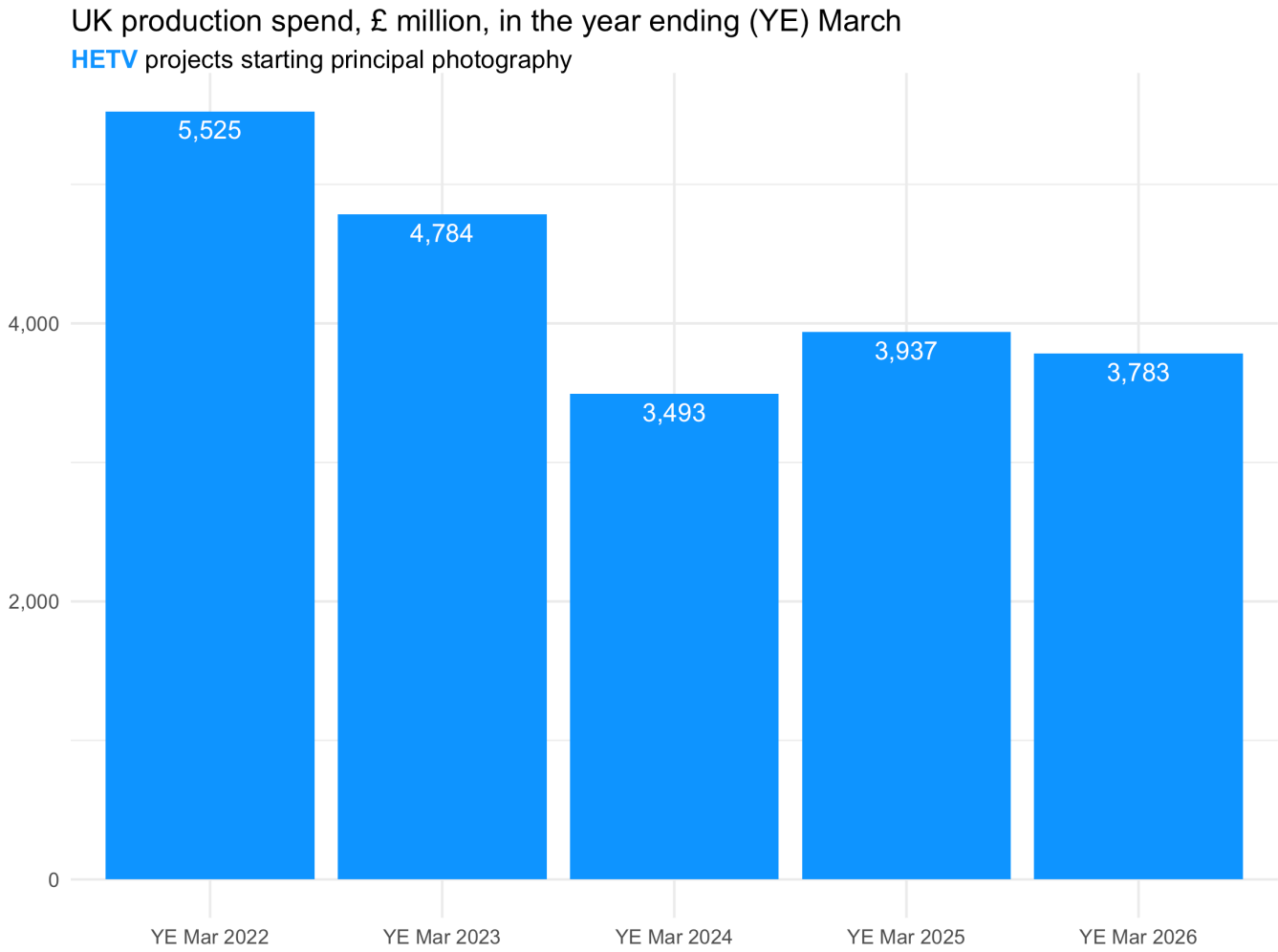
The BFI assigns productions to one of three categories:

- Inward investment features (INW)
- Domestic UK features (DOM)
- Co-productions (COP)

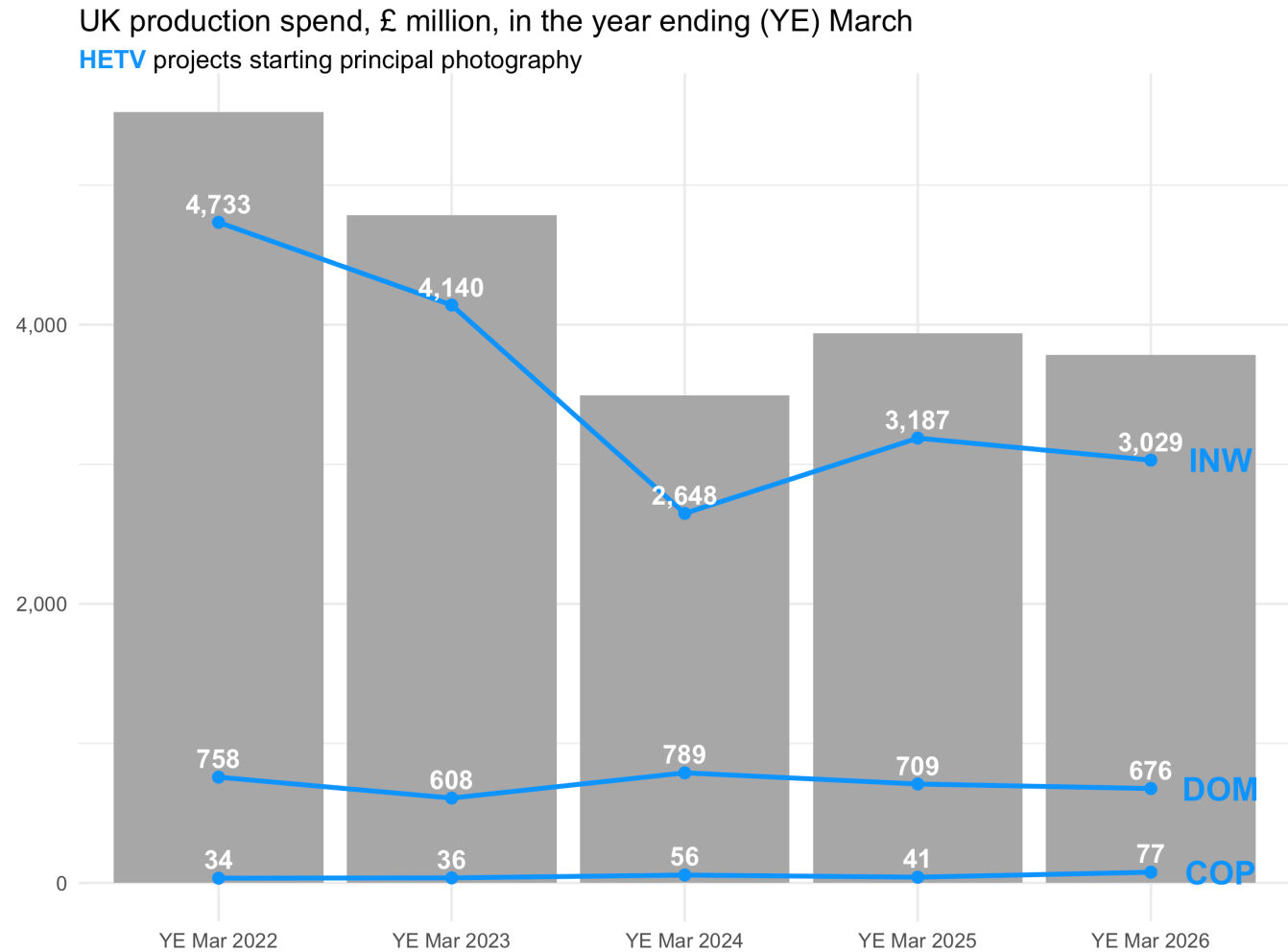
See [notes to statistics releases](#) for full definitions.



- UK spend on HETV projects was £3.78 billion in the 12 months to March 2026, down 4% on revised figures for the previous 12-month period.



- Spend on co-productions almost doubled compared with revised figures for the 12 months to March 2025.

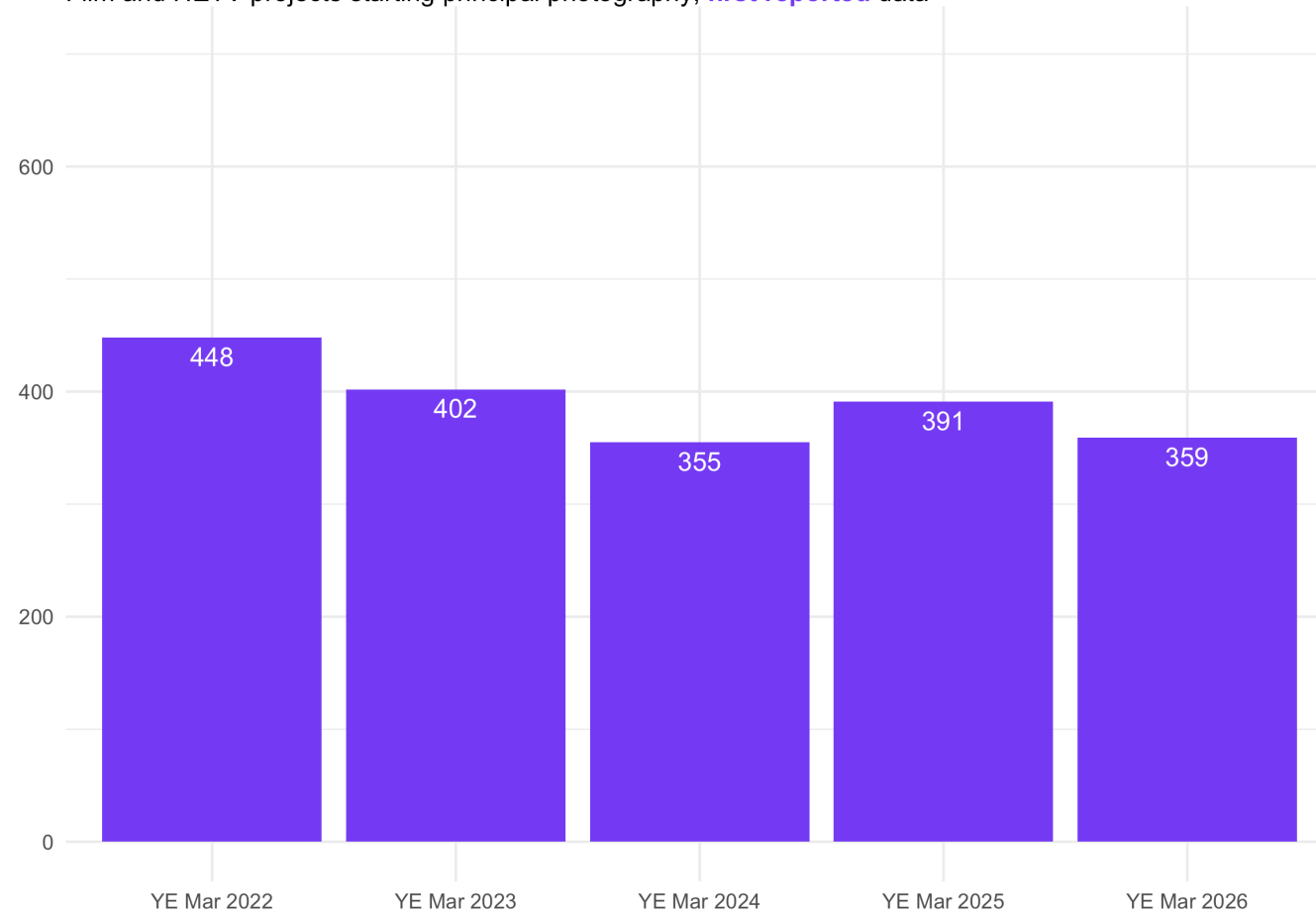


Film and HETV production count

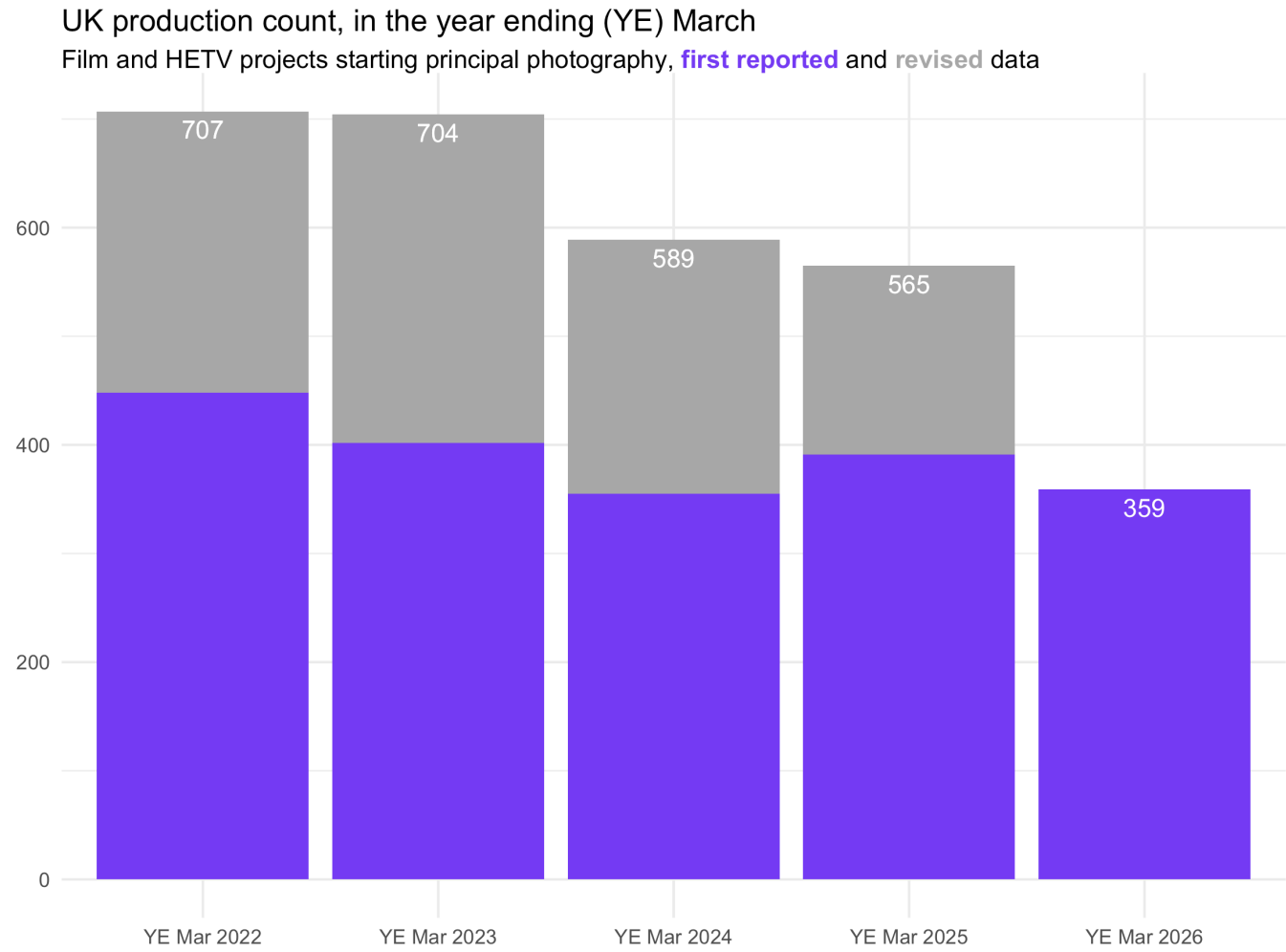
In the UK, in the 12 months to March 2026:

- Combined production starts were down 8% on first reported figures for the 12 months to March 2025.

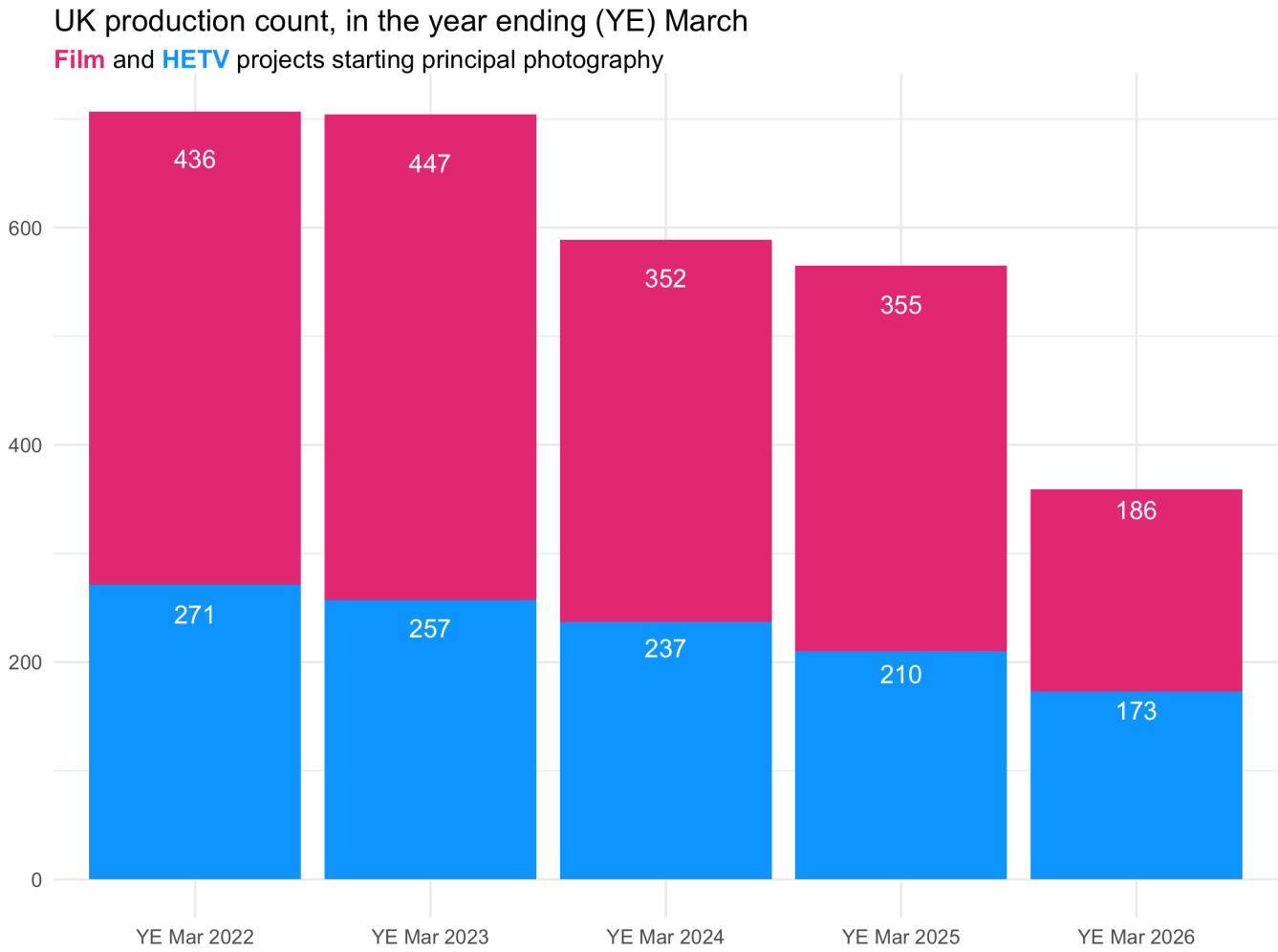
UK production count, in the year ending (YE) March
Film and HETV projects starting principal photography, **first reported** data



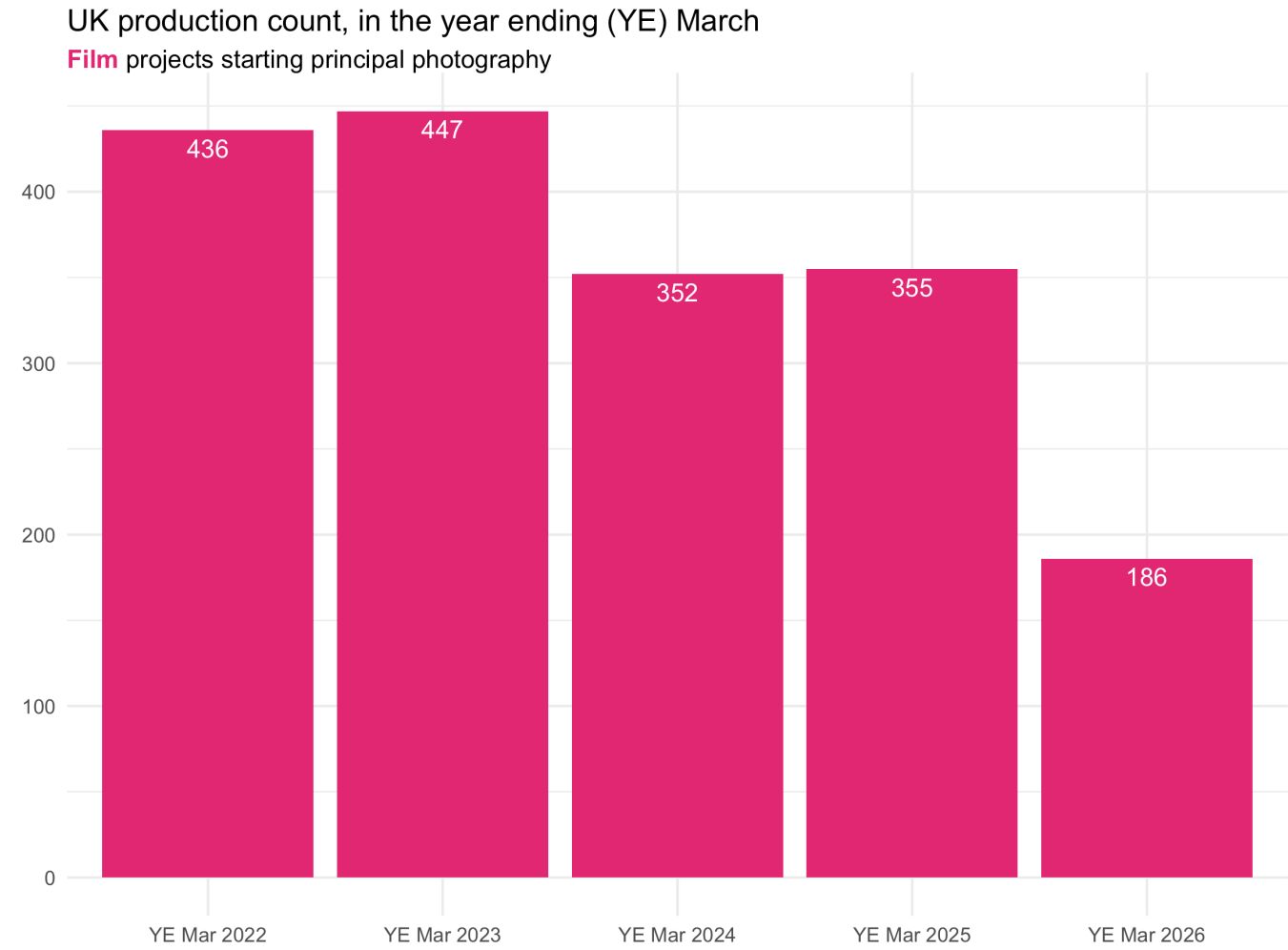
- Production count for the 12 months to March 2026 is lower than for the other periods shown here. However, as previously noted, figures are likely to be revised upward in subsequent statistical releases as more data becomes available.



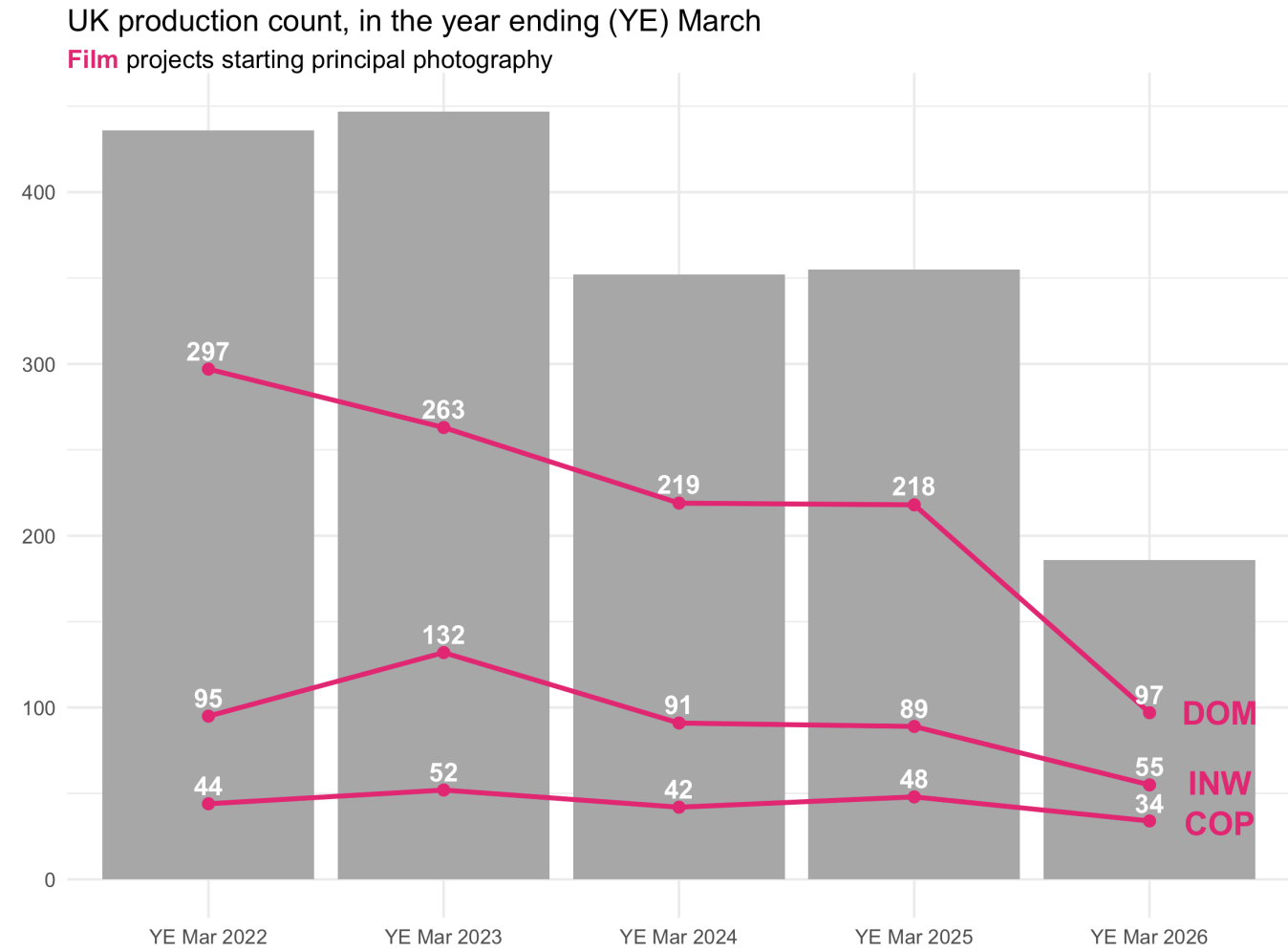
- We saw earlier that HETV accounted for the majority of UK production spend in the 12 months to March 2026. In terms of number of productions, however, film accounted for the majority: 52%.



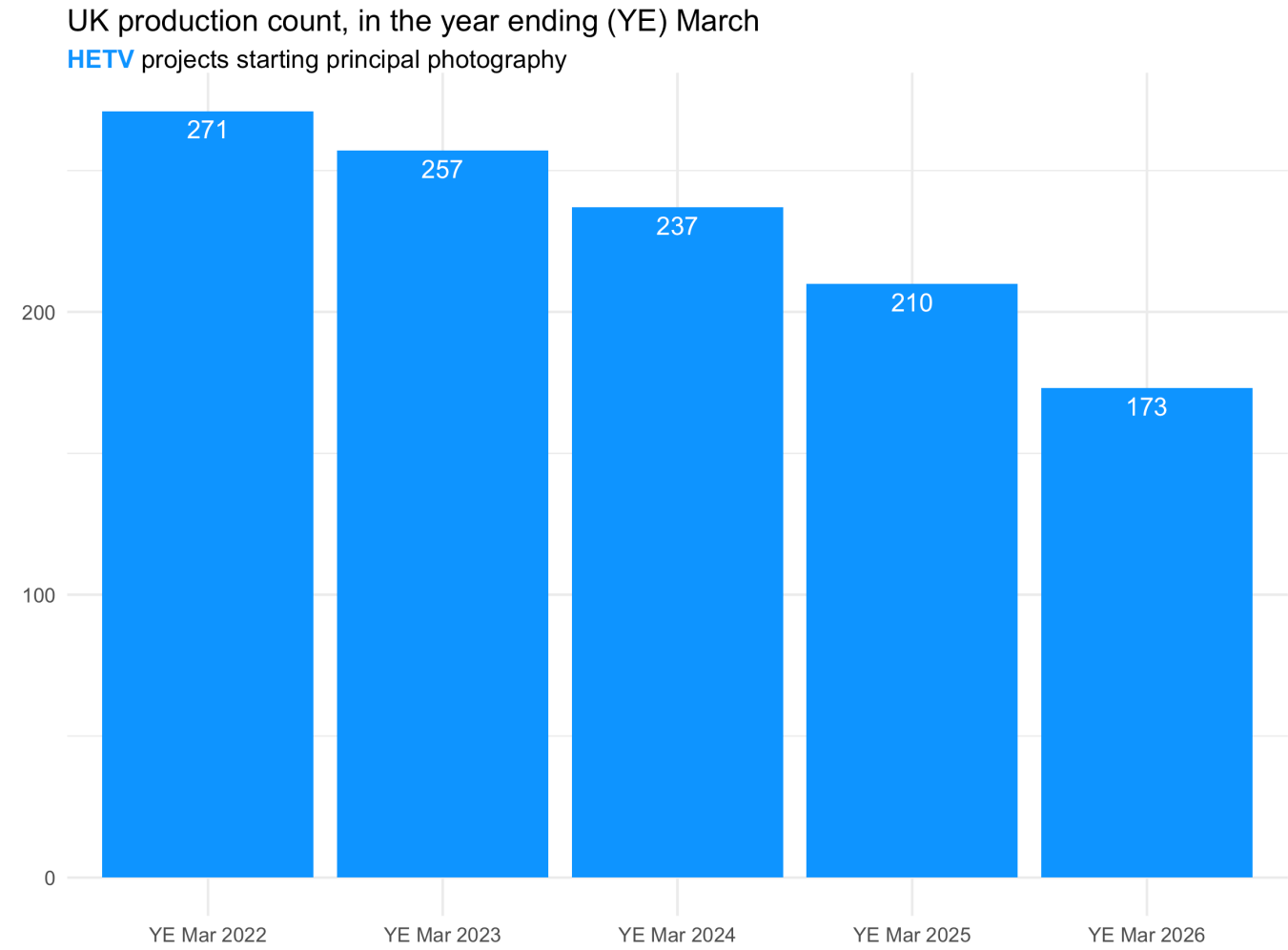
- 186 films were recorded as starting principal photography in the UK in the 12 months to March 2026.



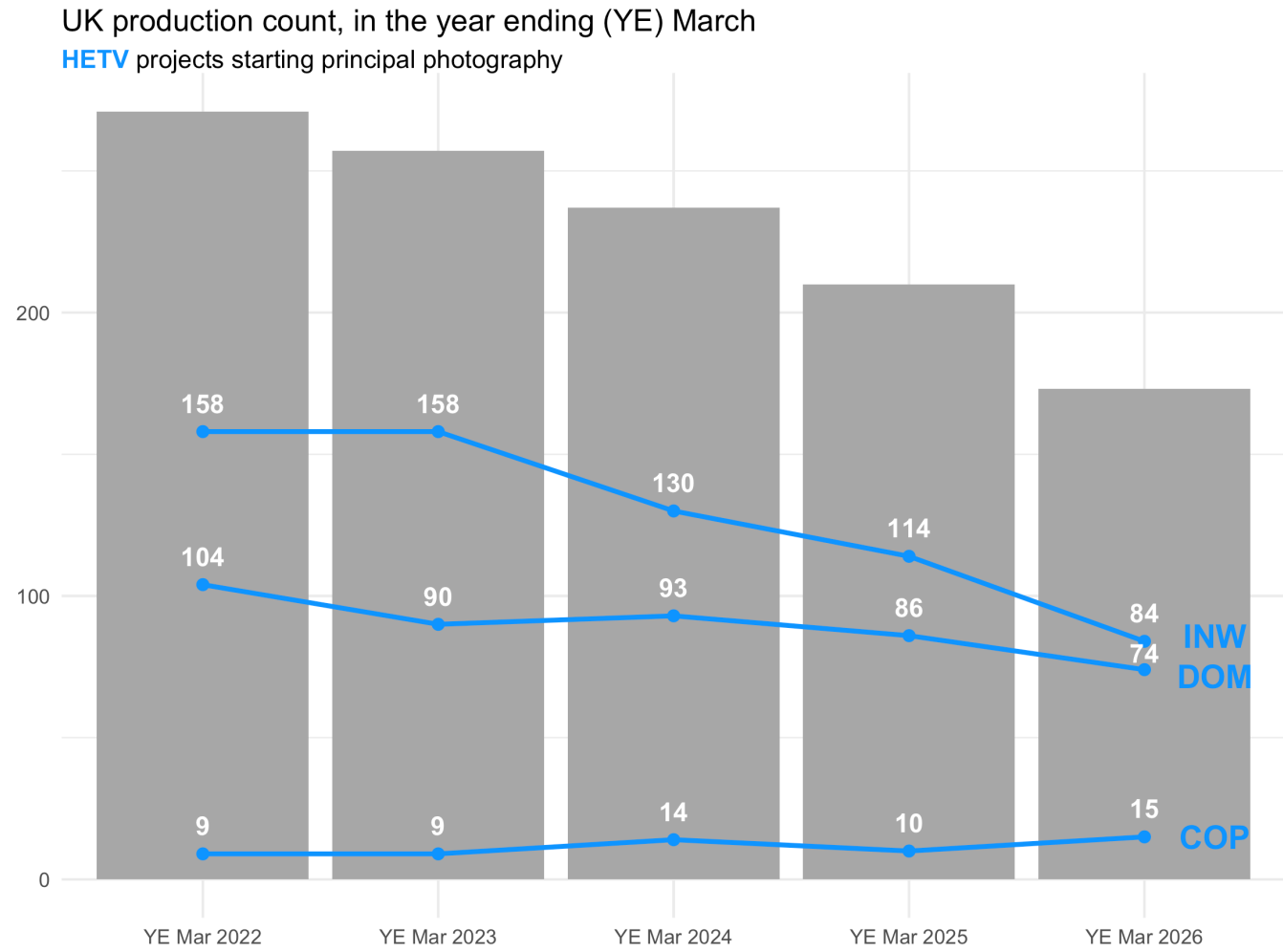
- Lags in obtaining complete data on production activity tend to disproportionately affect counts for domestic UK feature films (DOM), particularly those with budgets of less than £500,000.



- 173 HETV programmes were recorded as starting principal photography in the UK in the 12 months to March 2026.



- HETV programme starts in the 12 months to March 2026 included 13 feature-length single episode productions.

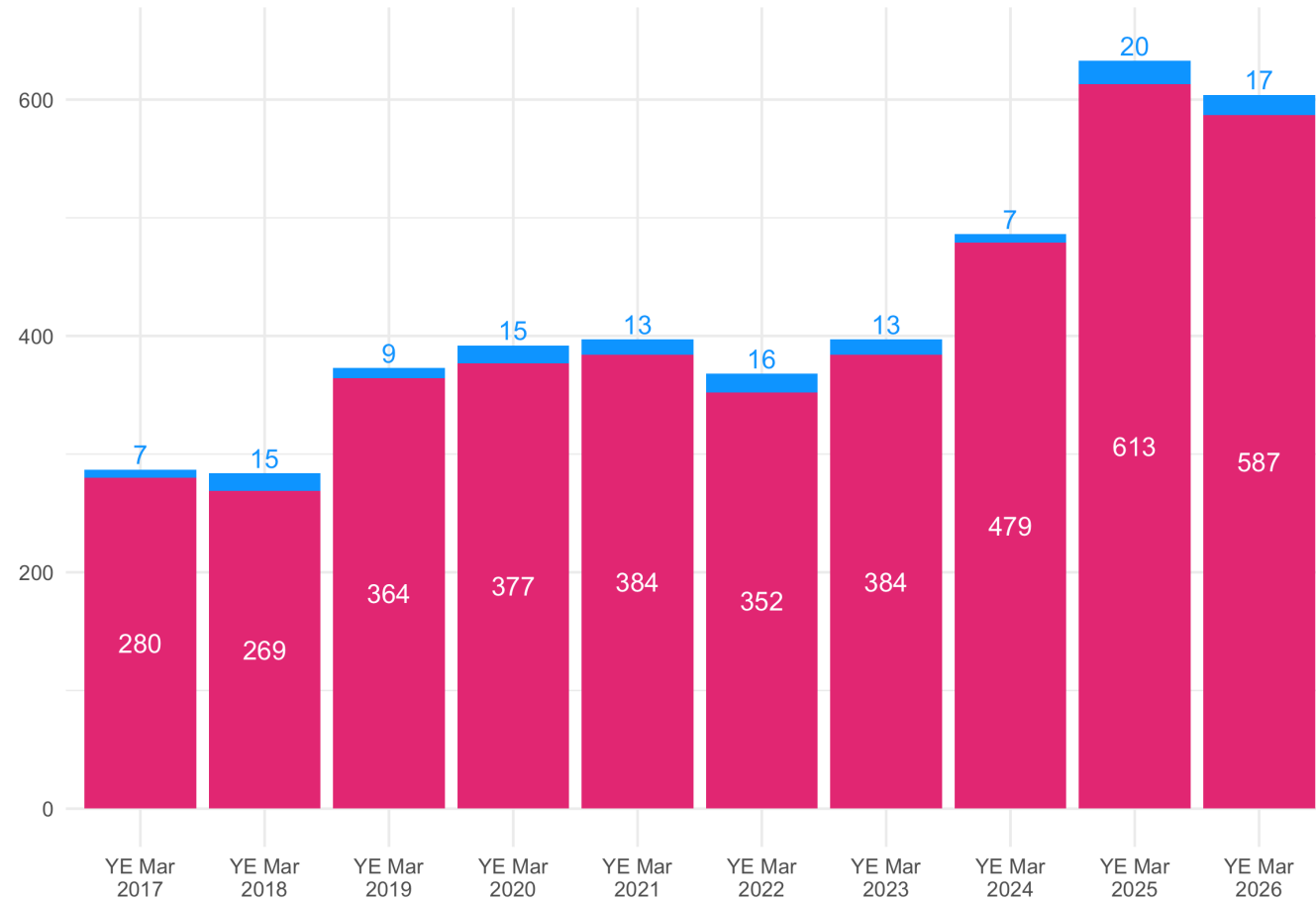


Certification

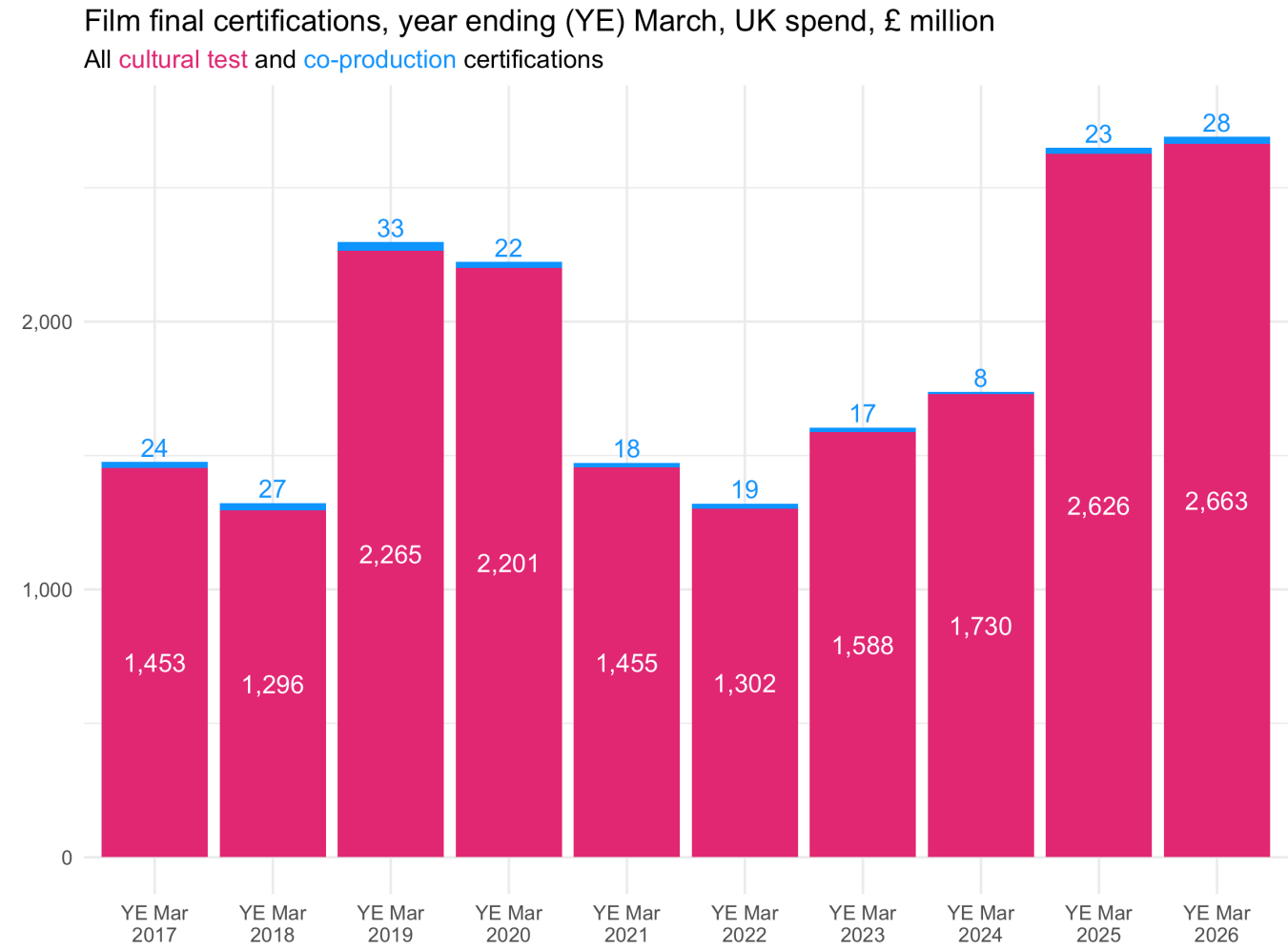
In the 12 months to March 2026:

- A total of 604 films received final certification, either under the cultural test or as an official co-production.
- Certification is required to access UK tax reliefs and credits for audiovisual and video game expenditure.

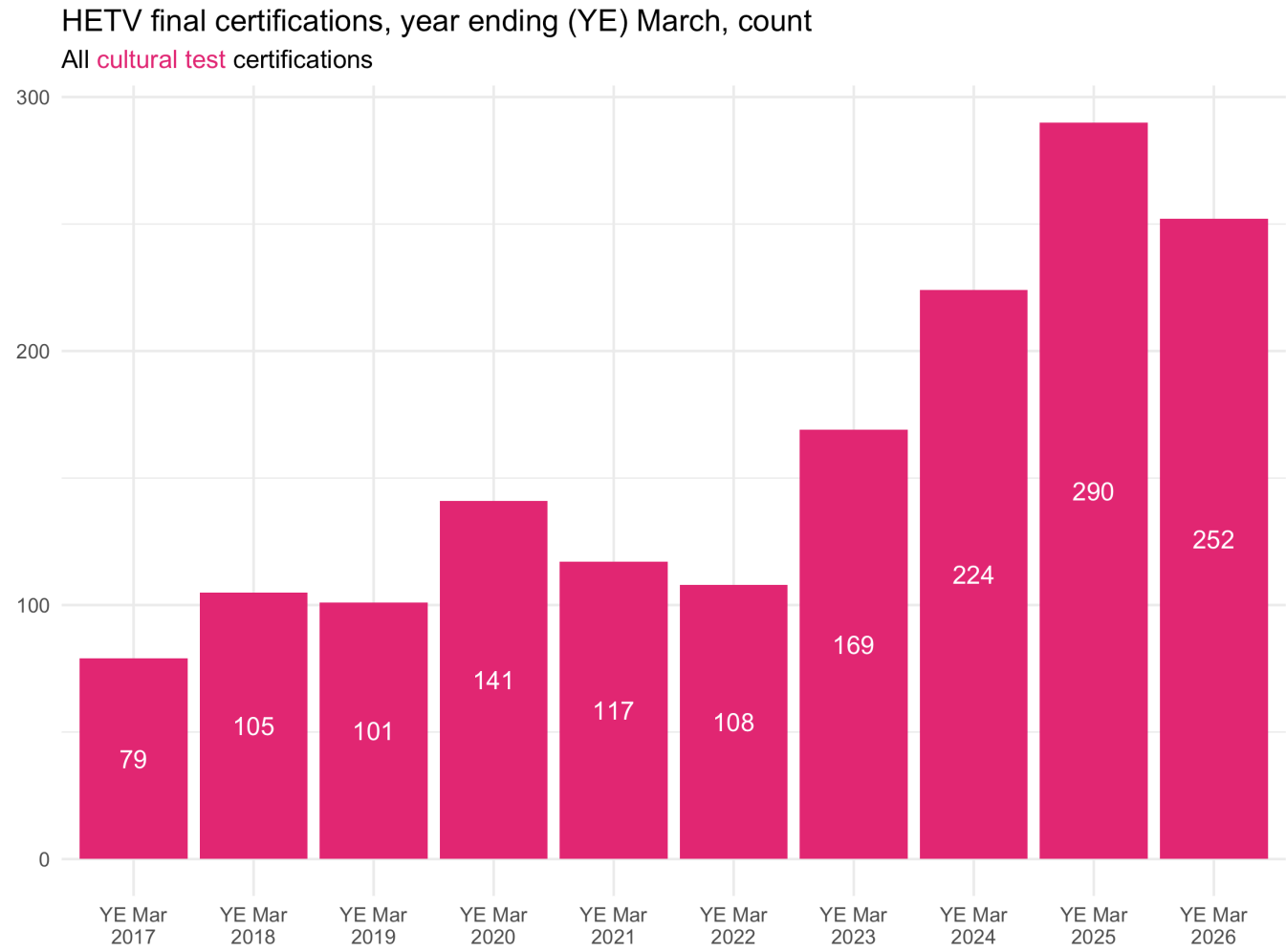
Film final certifications, year ending (YE) March, count
All cultural test and co-production certifications



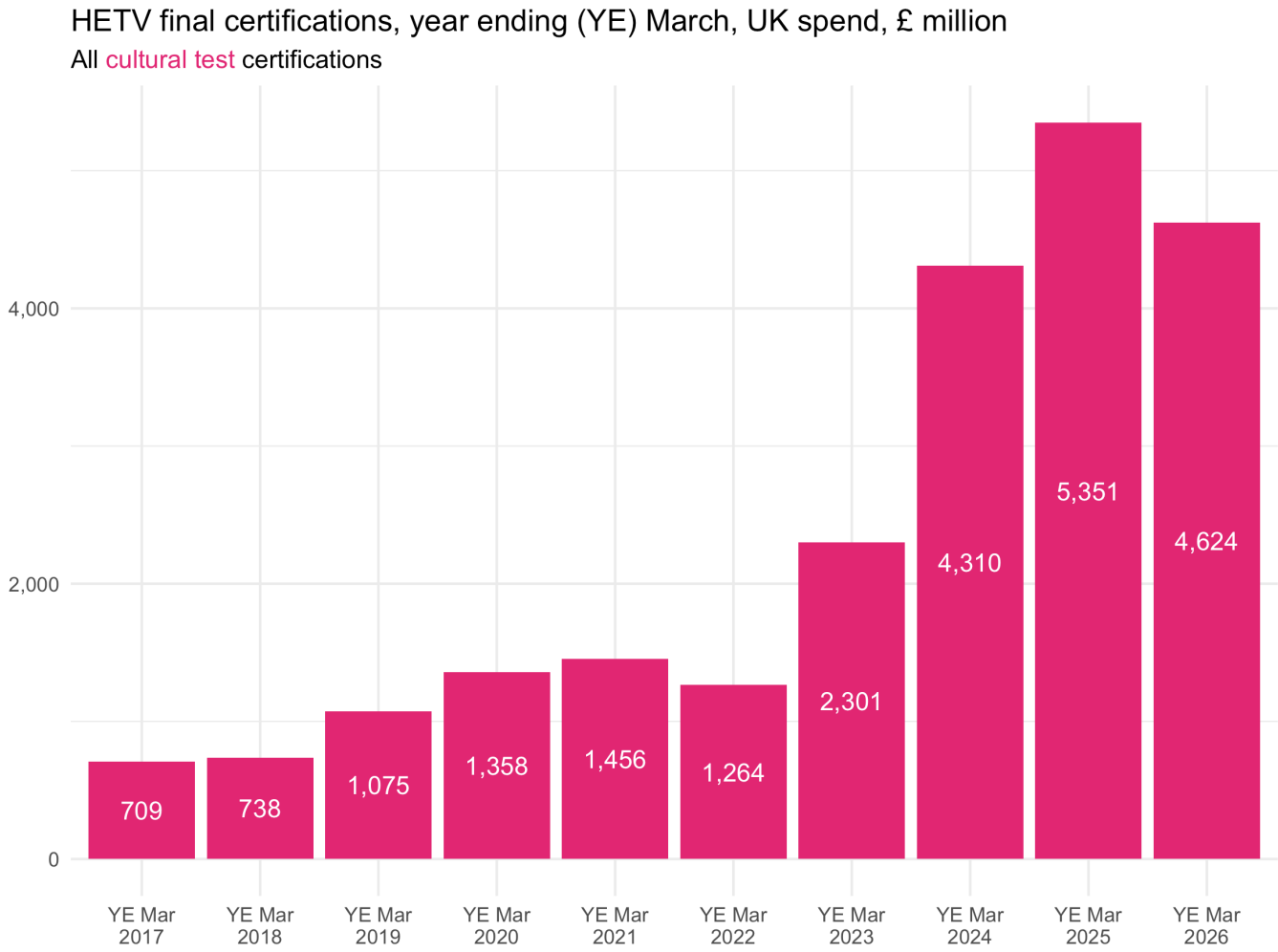
- Films achieving final certification in the 12 months to March 2026 had an associated UK production spend of £2.69 billion.
- Films and other productions can apply for final certification when they have completed production and are ready to be released.



- 252 HETV titles received final certification through the cultural test in the 12 months to March 2026.
- There were two co-productions with final certification but details are not included for disclosure control reasons.

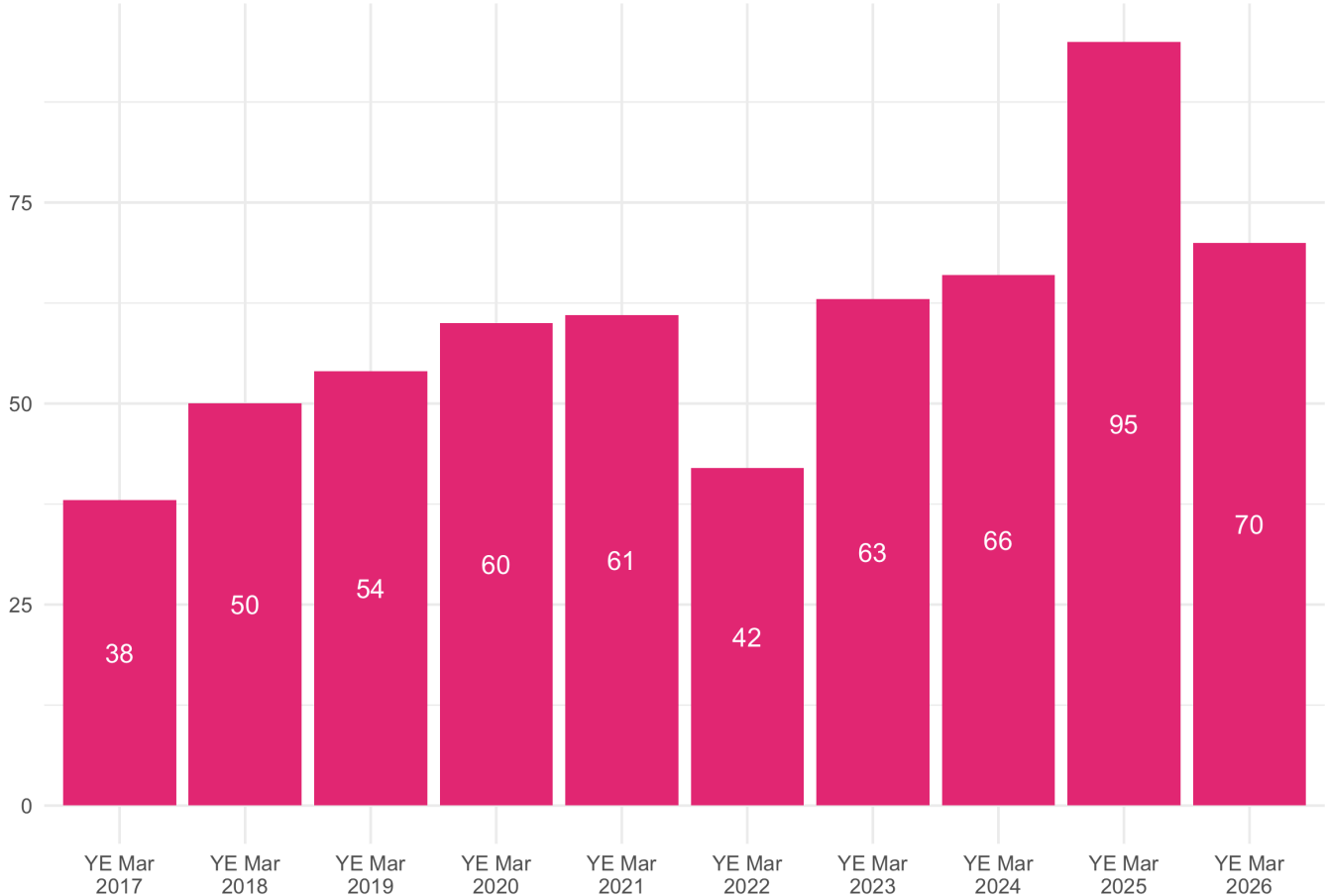


- HETV productions receiving final certification under the cultural test in the 12 months to March 2026 had a UK production spend of £4.62 billion.

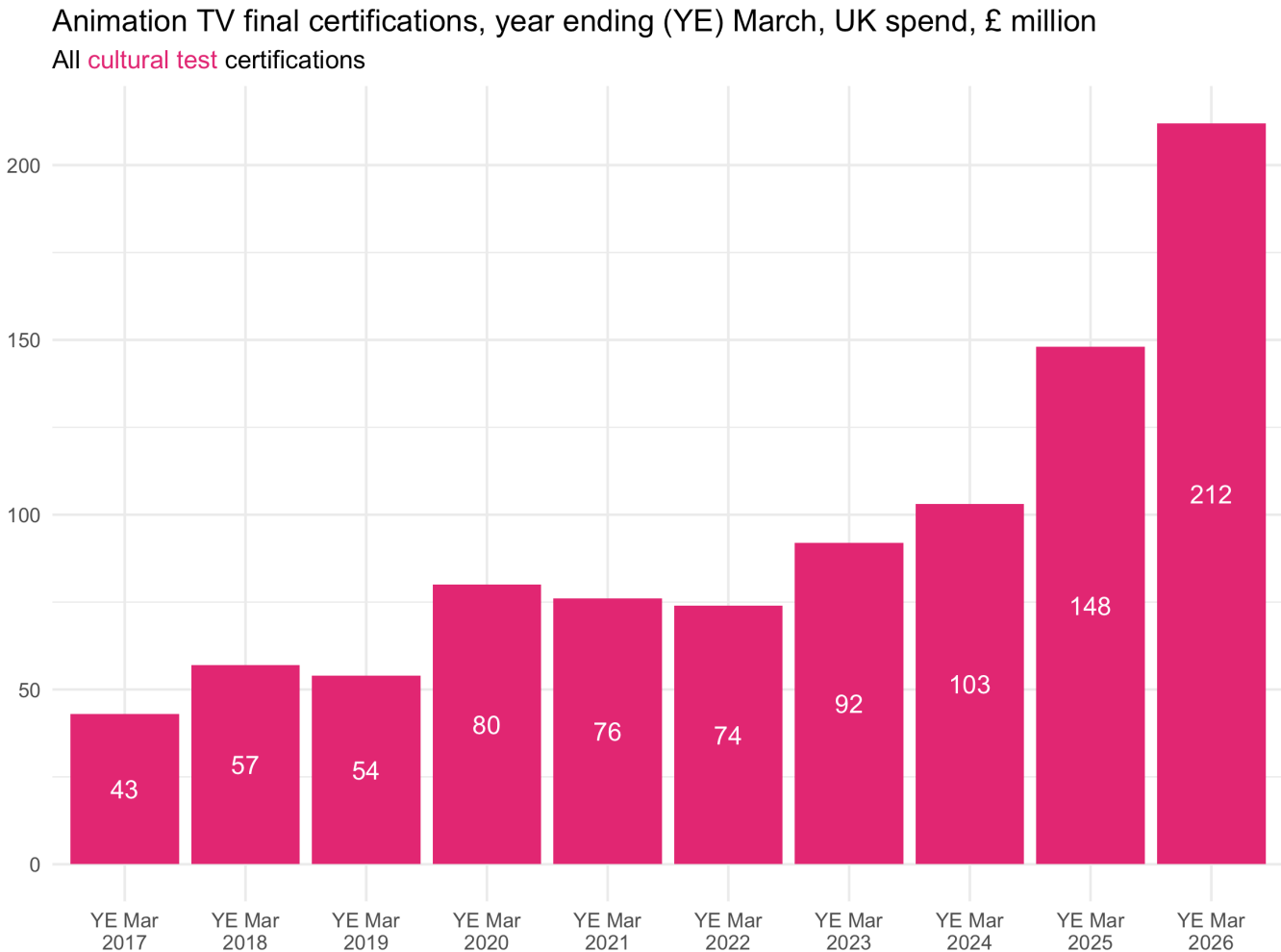


- 70 animation television programmes received final certification under the cultural test in the 12 months to March 2026.
- There were two co-productions with final certification but details are not included for disclosure control reasons.

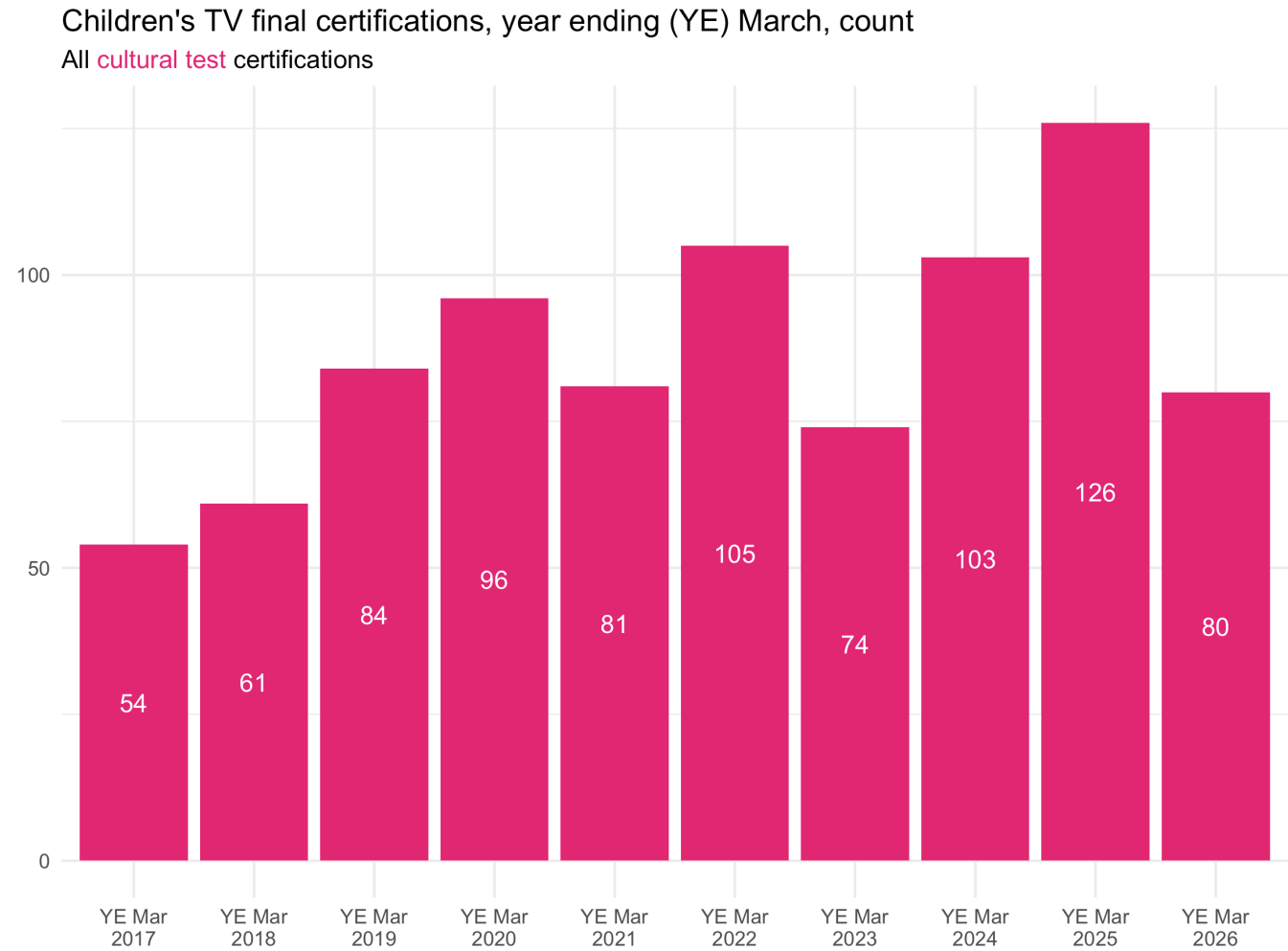
Animation TV final certifications, year ending (YE) March, count
All cultural test certifications



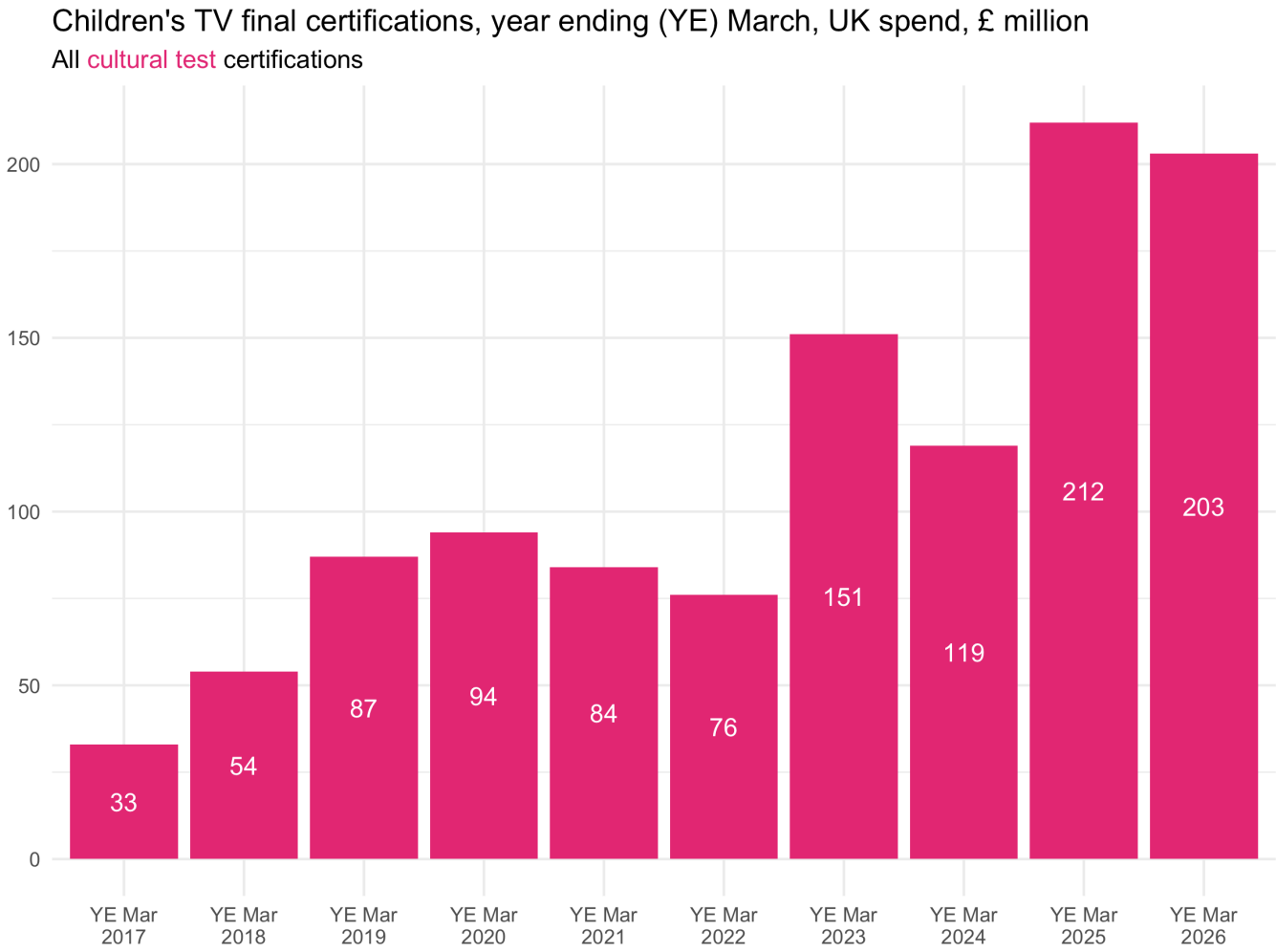
- Animation TV productions receiving final certification under the cultural test in the 12 months to March 2026 had a UK production spend of £212 million.



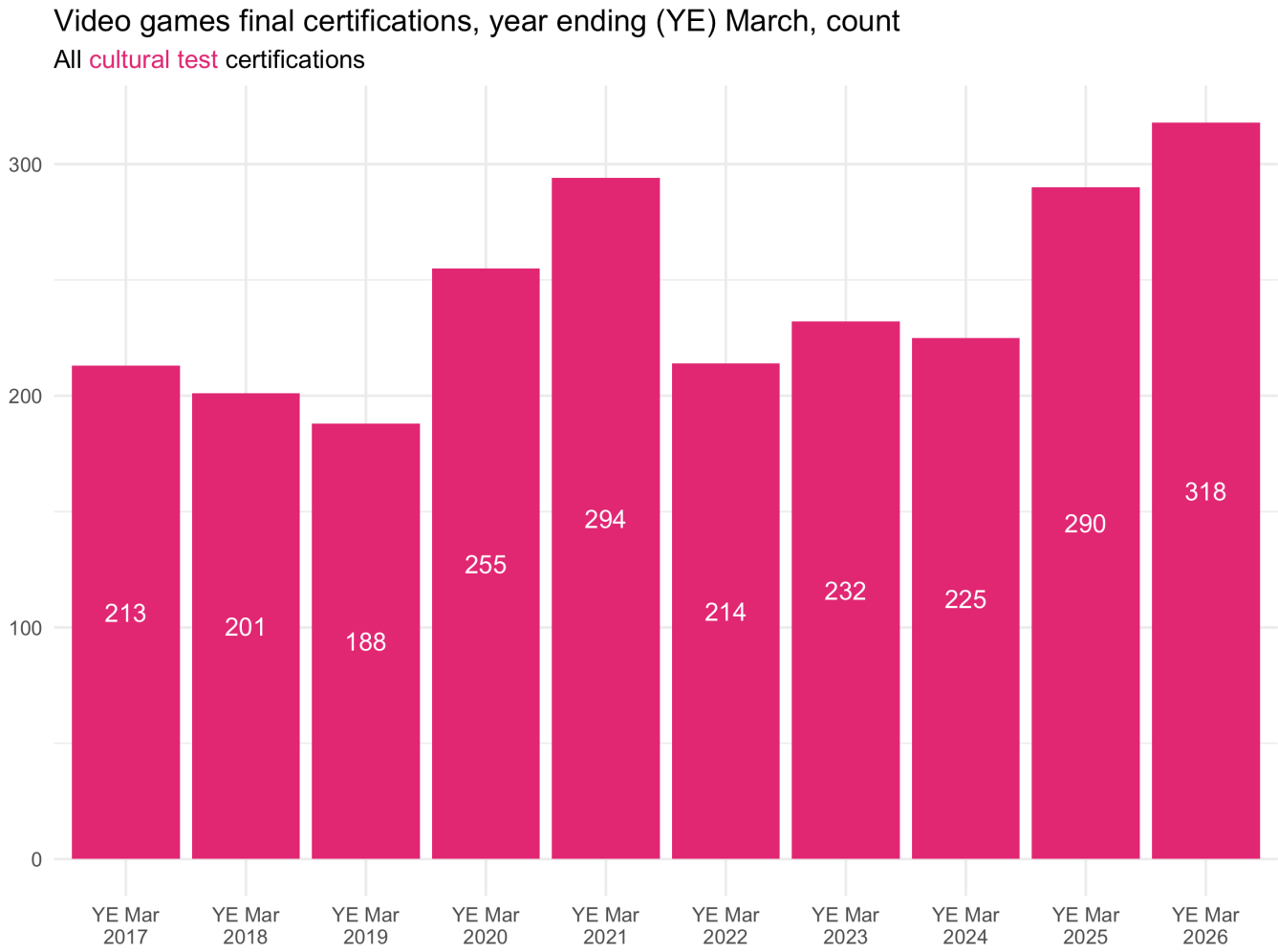
- 80 children’s television programmes received final certification under the cultural test in the 12 months to March 2026.
- There was one co-production with final certification but details are not included for disclosure control reasons.



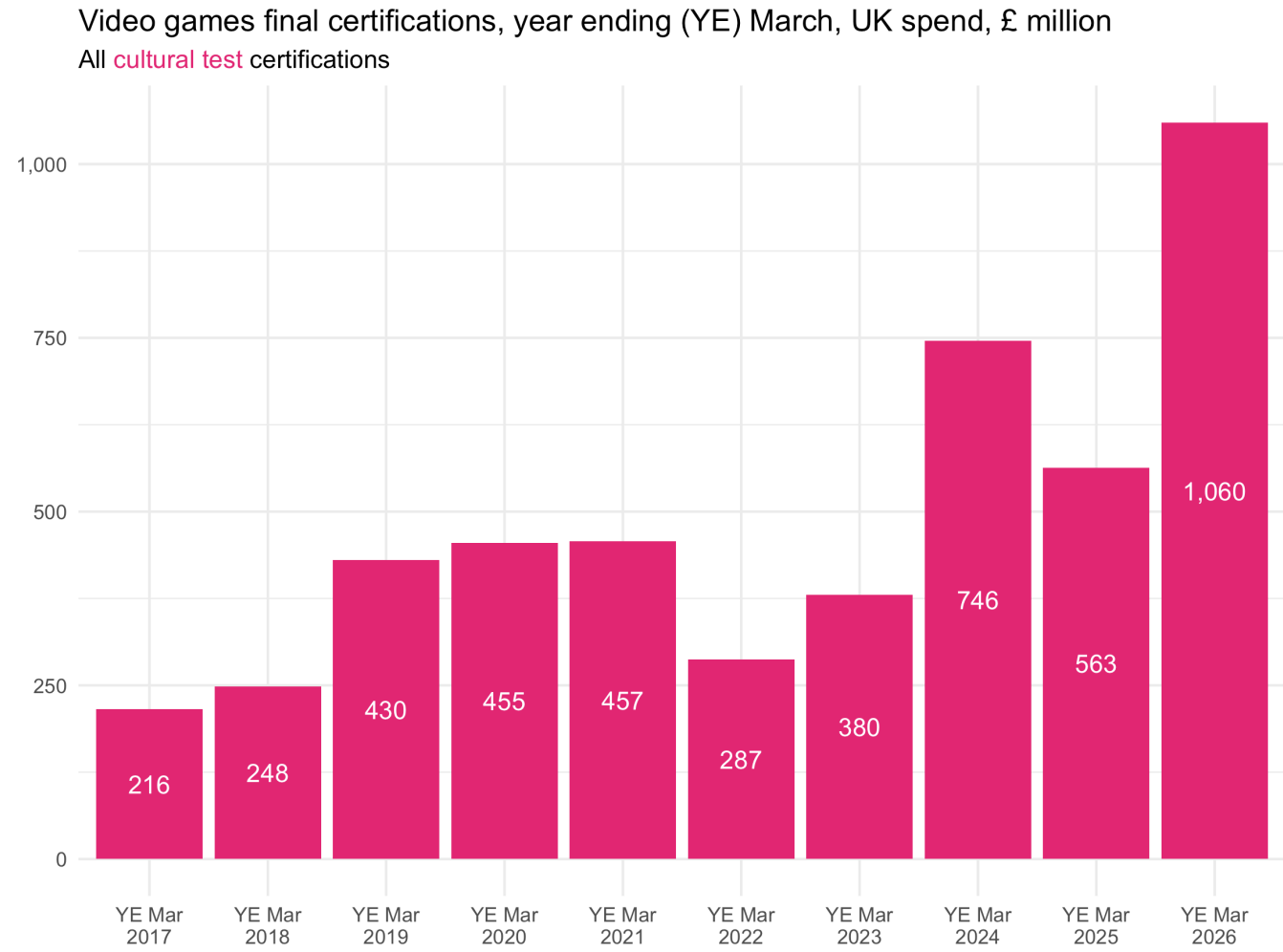
- Children’s TV productions receiving final certification under the cultural test in the 12 months to March 2026 had a UK production spend of £203 million.



- 318 video games received final certification in the 12 months to March 2026.
- Video games can only be certified under the cultural test.



- Video games receiving final certification in the 12 months to March 2026 had a UK production spend of £1.06 billion.



Sources

- Box office: Comscore, BFI Research & Statistics Unit
- Admissions: Cinema Advertising Association
- Production: BFI Research & Statistics Unit
- Certification: BFI Research & Statistics Unit, BFI Certification Unit

See [bfi.org.uk](https://www.bfi.org.uk) for more industry data and insights